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Mutual funds spread wider, bet lighter on IPOs

MEASURED APPETITE. Participation rebounds in 2026, but average investment per issue shrinks sharply as offerings turn smaller

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Veteran fund manager Samir Arora just days ago suggested that mutual funds stay away from IPOs for 30 days, arguing that the relentless supply of fresh paper has been weighing on the market. With domestic equities making little headway for quite some time now, his concern may find wider resonance.

Mutual funds are hardly staying away from IPOs. Fed by the seemingly endless SIP fountain of over ₹30,000 crore a month — apparently, a good part of it into equities — they are participating in more IPOs this year. However, what has changed is how much they are putting to work.

A *bl.portfolio* study shows that mutual funds have invested in about 79 per cent of IPOs for which data are available so far in 2026, up over six percentage points from 73.3 per cent in 2025. But the amount invested tells a different story. MF in-

vestment, measured against the aggregate size of IPOs launched, has fallen to 26.6 per cent in 2026 from 32.7 per cent last year and 34.8 per cent in 2024.

The divergence is even starker on a per IPO basis. Mutual funds invested an average of about ₹412 crore in every IPO they participated in this year compared with ₹749 crore in 2025 and ₹771 crore in 2024. Fund houses are saying yes more often, but with smaller sums.

Mutual funds invest in IPOs either through main book allocations (anchor and non-anchor portions) or via secondary market purchases post-listing. Due to limited visibility on non-anchor allocations, this study uses month-end MF disclosures to capture first-month holdings in 435 IPOs between CY2020 and CY2026 YTD.

For 2026, the study covers 61 of the 64 IPOs launched up to September 3, 2026. MF investment data, based on month-end portfolio disclosures, are available for 36 IPOs. For the remaining 25 IPOs, launched after July 31,

More IPOs get MF money, but less of it

Year	Investment in IPOs (₹ cr)*	Participation ratio (%)	Average investment per participated IPO (₹ cr)
2020	6,684	93	477
2021	26,985	95	442
2022	14,460	90	413
2023	12,561	80	262
2024	55,535	80	771
2025	57,668	73	749
2026 YTD**	19,785	79 ▲	412 ▼

Based on first month-end mutual fund portfolio disclosures for each IPO company.

**For 2026, MF investment data are available for 61 of the 64 IPOs launched up to September 3, 2026

Source: Capitaline and ACEMF, bl.portfolio compilation

IPO returns recover unevenly in 2026

Year	Average listing-day gain (%)	Average 30-day return (%)	Average 90-day return (%)
2020	43.3	41.7	52.7
2021	31.2	20.2	18.8
2022	9.7	10.2	15.9
2023	26.1	31.4	45.8
2024	29.0	29.1	28.7
2025	8.3	8.8	7.1
2026 YTD	12.9 ▲	7.9 ▼	24.8 ▲

Returns calculated from IPO issue price. For 2026, 30-day and 90-day averages include only IPOs that had completed the respective lock-in periods.

2026, for which MF disclosure data are not yet available, the data are based on the companies' post-allotment shareholding disclosures.

MORE AND LESS

The latest findings reverse part of the trend captured in our August 2025 article, 'Mutual funds turning choosy on IPOs'.

MF participation in IPOs had slipped from 95 per cent in 2021 to 90 per cent in 2022, 80 per cent in 2023 and 2024, and 73 per cent in 2025. But at about 79 per cent in 2026, participation is back to 2023 and 2024 levels.

Money, however, has not followed with the same enthusiasm. MF investment was equivalent to 23 per cent of the aggregate issue size in

2021 and 2022 and 24 per cent in 2023. It surged to 35 per cent in 2024 and remained elevated at 33 per cent in 2025. Against that backdrop, the 27 per cent figure in 2026 looks more like a cooling-off after two unusually aggressive years than a retreat from IPOs.

Selectivity may simply have moved from the front door to the dining table.

Funds are rejecting fewer IPOs outright but taking smaller helpings when they participate.

SIZE MATTERS

The 64 IPOs launched so far this year have raised ₹74,264 crore, giving an average issue size of about ₹1,160 crore. In 2025, 105 IPOs raised ₹1.77 lakh crore, or about ₹1,682 crore per issue. The average IPO has therefore been about 31 per cent smaller this year.

The 45 per cent fall in average investments per IPO by MFs is considerably sharper than the decline in average IPO size, suggesting that issue size alone may not explain the lighter MF investments. It may also indicate greater discipline in position sizing after the unusually heavy deployment seen in 2024 and 2025.

The picture can change quickly. Mega offerings such as Reliance Jio and NSE could make the final 2026 numbers look very different from today's market dominated by smaller issues.

So far in 2026, mutual funds have invested more

than ₹1,000 crore each in the IPOs of Indo-MIM, SBI Funds Management, Manipal Health and Amagi Media Labs. In contrast, they have largely avoided smaller IPOs such as GSP Crop Science, Rajputana Stainless and Technocraft Ventures.

RETURN TICKET

Average listing day gains improved to 12.9 per cent in 2026 from 8.3 per cent in 2025.

The picture after listing is mixed. Average returns after the 30-day lock-in period stand at 7.9 per cent, below last year's 8.8 per cent. But returns after the 90-day lock-in period average 24.8 per cent, sharply higher than 7.1 per cent in 2025.

So this is hardly a case of funds running away from IPOs. Instead, 2026 points to a more measured approach, with fund houses showing up more often but betting less. In IPO investing, attendance and appetite are two different things. This year, mutual funds have plenty of the former and noticeably less of the latter.

CBI books Subhash Chandra, others in ₹1,322-cr LICHL loan misappropriation and fraud case

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Subhash Chandra

The legal and financial controversies surrounding Subhash Chandra, founder of Zee Entertainment Enterprises Ltd. (ZEEL) and Essel Group, are far from over. Now, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has booked him and others on charges of misappropriating ₹1,322 crore borrowed from LIC Housing Finance Ltd. (LICHL).

The CBI acted on a complaint from LICHL on August 31, accusing Chandra and others of cheating, criminal conspiracy, and criminal breach of trust in connection with defaulted loan facilities.

It granted a loan of ₹500 crore to Vasant Sagar Properties Private Ltd. and Pan India Infra Projects Private Ltd. for business expansion after receiving a "letter of continuing guarantee" from Subhash

Chandra on March 28, 2018. Chandra also provided a certificate issued by DJM & Co. stating that his net worth was ₹59,113.21 crore as of March 31, 2017.

Another loan of ₹480 crore was extended to Digital Subscriber Management and Consultancy Services Private Ltd. and Spirit Infrapower and Multiventures Private Ltd. as a "rental discounting facility" under the Scheme of Rental Securitisation. This, too, was granted after LICHL secured a letter of continuing

guarantee from Chandra on August 10, 2018. In this case, the loan facility was approved on the basis of a certificate issued by MPJ & Co. and submitted by Chandra, stating that his net worth was ₹40,562 crore. "Thereafter, defaults occurred in the Vasant Sagar loan facility and the Digital loan facility," the CBI FIR stated.

NET-WORTH TWIST

According to the complaint filed with the premier investigating agency, Chandra, during subsequent proceedings under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016, "categorically denied having the net worth stated in the certificates" he had submitted to LICHL for approval of the loans. Chandra, acting in collusion with the borrowers — Vasant Sagar Properties, Pan India Infraprojects, Digital Subscriber Management, Spirit Infrapower and Mul-

tiventures — and their officers and directors, allegedly defrauded and cheated LICHL into advancing loans that were subsequently misappropriated, the complaint to the CBI stated.

Chandra allegedly created false documents to indicate an inflated and false net worth in order to deceive LICHL into disbursing funds to the principal borrowers.

Under personal insolvency resolution proceedings before the National Company Law Tribunal, Chandra proposed a repayment plan of ₹6.25 crore against total admitted creditor claims of over ₹22,000 crore. While the plan saw initial NCLT approval, it faced strong resistance from financial institutions like LICHL. Chandra's office clarified that the large claim figures stemmed from personal guarantees for corporate loan rather than direct personal borrowings.

TCS arm to set up ₹70,000-cr 1 GW AI data centre in Hyderabad

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

HyperVault, a subsidiary of Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), will set up a 1-GW AI data centre campus on 164 acres in Hyderabad.

The company and its partners plan to invest ₹70,000 crore in building the campus, which will be developed in phases. The announcement followed a meeting between TCS CEO and MD K Krithivasan and Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy on Saturday.

The campus will be purpose-built to serve frontier AI companies and hyperscalers, enabling high-density GPU deployments for AI training, inference, and advanced computing workloads. The project is expected to create 7,000 direct and indirect jobs.

Read more on p12

WHEN RIVER TAKES OVER



RISING WATERS. A house lies partially submerged in floodwaters following a rise in the water level of the Ganga river at Nakta Diyara in Patna, Bihar. The Ganga water level breached the 'highest flood mark' at Gandhi Ghat and Pandarak on Saturday morning, amid heavy rain. "Due to the rise in water levels, around 10.26 lakh people in 50 blocks covering 201 gram panchayats across 11 districts have been affected by the floods," the State Disaster Management Department said. [PTI](#)

Tata Motors arm launches tender offer for Iveco shares to seal €3.82-billion takeover

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Tata Motors has cleared regulatory hurdles and lined up financing for its €3.82-billion takeover of Iveco Group. Its final challenge is the company's shareholders.

ALL-CASH OFFER

Tata Motors CV and Iveco Group, in an exchange filing on September 5, announced the commencement of an all-cash voluntary tender offer by TML CV Holdings B.V. to acquire 100 per cent of Iveco's common shares and delist the Italian truck maker from Euronext Milan.

The offer is priced at €14.10 a share on a cum-dividend basis. Exor, Iveco's largest shareholder, has already committed its 27.06 per cent stake, representing about 43.19 per cent of voting rights.

The shareholder tender opens on September 7.

Tata has committed financing of up to €3.825 billion through Morgan Stanley and MUFG Bank. The tender closes on October 26, with payment scheduled for October 30.

"The commencement of the tender offer marks an important milestone," Tata Motors MD and CEO Girish Wagh said, adding that the combination could create "a stronger, more globally competitive commercial vehicle business".

CLEARANCES SECURED

The filing follows Italian securities regulator CONSOB's approval of the offer document on September 3 and the European Central Bank authorisation on September 1, completing the required regulatory clearances. Tata enters the shareholder phase with con-



The offer is priced at €14.10 a share on a cum-dividend basis [REUTERS](#)

siderable backing. Iveco's board has unanimously recommended that shareholders accept the offer and approve related resolutions at an Extraordinary General Meeting on October 16.

TWO ROUTES

Iveco CEO Olof Persson said the combination would create "a major new force in global commercial vehicles". Tata's preferred

route is to secure at least 95 per cent of Iveco's shares. At that level, it can use Dutch law to buy out the remaining minority shareholders and take 100 per cent ownership.

If Tata falls short of 95 per cent, it has a second route. Iveco shareholders will vote on October 16 on a restructuring that, if approved, lowers the minimum acceptance threshold to 80 per cent. Crossing 80 per cent would allow Tata to use a pre-agreed restructuring mechanism to acquire the remaining business and ultimately delist Iveco.

Exor's committed 27.06 per cent stake gives Tata a substantial head start. If the 80 per cent route becomes available, Tata needs another 52.94 per cent of Iveco's total shares — or roughly three out of every four shares not held by Exor — to get across the line.

RBI okays LIC's application to acquire up to 9.99% stake in ICICI Bank

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has accorded its approval to the Life Insurance Corporation of India's application to acquire an 'aggregate holding' of up to 9.99 per cent in ICICI Bank's paid-up share capital.

The acquisition of shares should occur within one year from the date of the RBI approval letter (September 4, 2026), failing which, the RBI approval shall stand cancelled, ICICI Bank said in a regulatory filing.

The approval is subject to certain conditions, including compliance with the relevant statutory and regulatory provisions, it added.

As of June 2026, LIC had a 4.35 per cent stake in



As of June 2026, LIC had a 4.35 per cent stake in ICICI Bank [REUTERS](#)

ICICI Bank, India's second-largest private sector bank.

REGULATORY CAP

Regulations do not allow India's largest life insurer to hold more than a 10 per cent stake in any other bank as it is the promoter of IDBI Bank.

LIC holds a 49.24 per cent majority stake in IDBI Bank. The government is the next biggest shareholder, with a 45.48 per

cent stake in the bank. Among the large banks in which LIC holds stakes are State Bank of India (8.53 per cent), HDFC Bank (4.77 per cent), Axis Bank (7.87 per cent), Punjab National Bank (8.83 per cent), and Bank of Baroda (5.14 per cent through LIC New Pension Plus Secured Fund).

PURPOSEFUL INVESTING

In a recent interaction with *businessline*, LIC CEO and MD R Doraiswamy had said, "LIC has historically been a promoter of several important institutions.... As a financial institution, we had to look at various options for investing funds in the interests of policyholders. There was also a nation-building objective, because the country needed to create institutions, and we were part of that initiative." The LIC

Chief emphasised that today, some of these investments are in a position to generate good returns and can potentially be monetised.

He noted that LIC had significant investments in institutions such as Corporation Bank and Oriental Bank of Commerce, as well as in some smaller scheduled commercial banks, and many of those investments had delivered good results.

"However, circumstances have changed over time, including through bank mergers. When we took a larger stake in IDBI Bank, there were conditions, including the requirement that we could not hold more than 10 per cent in any commercial bank. Therefore, we had to realign our investments accordingly," Doraiswamy said.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

Technical call: The New India Assurance Company (₹229.91)

Akhil Nallamuthu
Research Bureau

The long-term prospect for the stock is bullish.

The chart shows the formation of a higher base at ₹117 in April this year compared to ₹78 made in July 2022.

BULLISH MOMENTUM

Last week's rally indicates that the momentum has shifted in favour of the bulls. Within two years from now, the stock is likely to surpass its prior high of ₹382.20 and appreciate to ₹420.

Participants can buy now at ₹229 and buy more shares if the price drops to ₹180. Place a stop-loss at ₹110. When the price touches ₹300 and ₹360, revise the stop-loss to ₹260 and ₹330, respectively. Book profits at ₹420.

WISE WORDS.

“Investment risk comes primarily from too high prices, and too high prices often come from excessive optimism and inadequate skepticism and risk aversion

HOWARD MARKS
Co-founder of Oaktree Capital Management

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX

Week ago 77,265
Latest 76,515
Change (%) ▼ -1.0



NIFTY

Week ago 24,176
Latest 23,898
Change (%) ▼ -1.1



Unmasking the RED HERRING

DECODED. For serious investors, the RHP holds clues beyond the hype. Here's a guide to navigating mounds of data in a prospectus

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl, research bureau

The primary market is buzzing. In 2026, so far, 68 mainboard IPOs have raised about ₹90,000 crore or about \$9.5 billion. This even as some of the large, most anticipated IPOs of Jio Platforms and NSE are in the pipeline. While Jio Platforms is expected to raise about ₹38,000 crore and become India's largest IPO ever, NSE's offer-for-sale is estimated at ₹30,000 crore.

For serious investors keen to participate in the primary market, poring over the red herring prospectus (RHP or simply, prospectus) is important. Yet, the task can be daunting as the prospectus itself runs into hundreds of pages and even into thousands, at times.

SEBI, the regulator, on its part has brought the 'abridged RHP' which is a concise summary of the original prospectus. It is short yet effective in helping an investor get started with the analysis in about 10-15 pages. Investors can get a good idea of what the company is and how it is doing in about an hour, going through the abridged RHP. However, should you skip the main prospectus if you are done with the abridged RHP? What does the abridged version miss? How should you go about the main RHP? Here is a lowdown.

WHERE CAN I DOWNLOAD RHP?

<https://www.sebi.gov.in/> >Filings >Public Issues >Red Herring Documents filed with ROC >Look for the company's name

ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS

The abridged prospectus effectively condenses the longer RHP in about 10-15 pages. Typically, it contains a summary of the company's business, the industry it operates in, summary financials, KPIs (key performance indicators) and a table showing the pre-IPO stake held by promoters and top 10 public shareholders. Within business, the document contains details of the products/services offered, break-up of revenue by geography and operating segments, concentration of revenue with top five customers, key manufacturing facilities and the company's strengths and strategies.

Besides, the abridged RHP contains short descriptions of the objects of the offer, background of the promoters, top 10 internal risk factors, board composition, outstanding litigations and auditor qualifications, if any.

Investors who have been analysing RHPs for long might be aware that the abridged RHP is not something new. Earlier, it was part of the main RHP under a section called 'Summary of the issue document'. However, delivering the same as a separate 'abridged RHP' should evoke investor interest for its condensed, succinct form.

Here's our take on the abridged RHP. The abridged prospectus does a great job introducing the company to the investor but leaves serious investors wanting for more. For instance, the summary financials only contain a few line items such as revenue, PAT, EPS and net worth from the full financial statements. Financial statements must be read with accompanying notes which are absent in the abridged prospectus. The all important 'management's discussion and analysis' section is available only in the main RHP and so are the granular details pertaining to how the company intends to deploy the fresh issue proceeds.

Yet, we recommend investors start with the

abridged RHP and set a context about the company, before moving on to the main RHP. A full reading of the abridged RHP is advised.

ABRIDGED RHP CHECKLIST

- Know if there is a fresh issue component
- If so, find out the objects behind the fund raise
- Check if pre-IPO promoters' controlling stake is maintained after the IPO
- Understand business, revenue model and market share
- Internalise the company's scale, profitability and indebtedness

Round off a thorough reading of the abridged RHP with the outstanding litigations, audit qualifications and risk factors. Most companies may not have material litigations and audit observations. Focus more on the litigations 'against' the company and its subsidiaries and measure the amount involved in litigations against its net worth. Reading the top 10 risk factors should suffice in most cases as the other risk factors in the main RHP may largely have to do with general regulatory disclosures.

SANITY CHECKS

It's time to download the main prospectus now. While still on the topic of litigations and audit observations, your first step in reviewing the main RHP should be to conduct a few basic sanity checks. These help rule out the likelihood of investing in a company engaged in questionable practices.

DUE DILIGENCE CHECKLIST

- Go to summary of related party transactions (RPTs)
- Check if management remuneration is disproportionate to revenue. If it is over 5 per cent of revenue, see if it is justified. If closer to 10 per cent, it is definitely excessive and could be a red flag.
- Check if there are material unsecured loans (as a % of assets) given to promoter-linked entities
- Check whether sales to and purchases from related entities form a significant portion of revenue or purchases, to confirm that the company is not involved in round tripping
- Look up contingent liabilities for lawsuits and corporate guarantees
- As a rule of thumb, contingent liabilities below 10% of net worth should be tolerable. Else, factor it in valuation.

MANAGEMENT DISCUSSION & ANALYSIS

Once making sure that you are studying a rather clean company, head over to 'management discussion & analysis' (MDA). It is probably the only part of the prospectus that blends qualitative aspects of the business, like revenue model, quantitative (non-GAAP measures or KPIs) and financial data in one place. Hence, MDA makes it convenient for an investor to conduct fundamental analysis. MDA typically tops at 30-40 pages, and a thorough study of MDA should make it easy for you in the subsequent stages of the analysis.

Here's a step-by-step approach.

1. Most RHPs begin MDA with a brief description of the business and revenue model. If absent, your reading of the abridged RHP should suffice for now.
2. Use the 'principal factors affecting results of operations' part to understand the drivers responsible for the company's growth. These include internal drivers and industry tailwinds. For instance, growth in AUM, folios were mentioned as an internal driver of growth for SBI Funds Management. Stringent emission norms in the future were mentioned as an industry tailwind for Tenneco Clean Air.
3. Use the table on KPIs or non-GAAP measures to see if the drivers of revenue growth are on an uptrend. These include GMV for an e-commerce company, number of keys for a hospitality company, loan growth for an NBFC, area of leaseable properties for a real estate player, so on and so forth.
4. Make use of the common size P&L statement (all items given as a percentage of revenue) to infer how revenue flows through costs down to the bottom line. Check if revenue, operating profit (EBITDA) and net profit are growing and calculate CAGRs for comparison with peers later.
5. Go through management's explanation of the year-on-year rise or decline in each of the items of P&L as it will give good clarity.
6. Analyse the nature of cost items (variable/fixed) to see if the company can benefit from operating leverage. This is more relevant for platform businesses such as Turtlemint Fintech Solutions, listed in 2026. At the time of its IPO, the company's adjusted EBITDA loss narrowed to ₹108 crore in 9M FY26 from ₹143 crore in 9M FY25, driven by flat fixed costs and an 82 per cent year-on-year expansion in service margin (akin to contribution margin).
7. Always have notes to accounts (part of restated financial information) by your side when you analyse financial statements to infer what goes into each line item of P&L and balance sheet.

Once done, move on to ratio analysis. While there are many ratios to consider, the ones you should not miss are given in the graphic. Other ratios such as working capital days, RoE/ RoCE can be analysed along with those of peer companies, using the 'basis for offer price' segment.

BUSINESS AND INDUSTRY

Once done with the above, the rest of the prospectus should be a breeze. 'Industry overview'

and 'our business' are two large segments that an investor must go through, though the rigour maintained so far may not be required.

CHECKLIST FOR INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

- Understand that the prospectus is ultimately the company's sales pitch. Treat projected industry figures with a pinch of salt.
- Exercise caution when assuming the total addressable market (TAM) of the company. It must be commensurate with the company's products and capabilities. Readers can recall from our analysis of SpaceX's IPO (edition dated May 24, 2026) as to how the company had suggested an absurd figure of about \$28.5 trillion as its TAM, which is almost of 90 per cent of US' GDP.
- Find out the relevant industry's projected growth rate. It is better to have a growth rate that exceeds that of nominal GDP.
- In fast growing or underpenetrated markets like financial services, the profit pool expands year after year and so, competition perhaps is less of a concern. On the contrary, the company's market share and moats do matter if the underlying market is mature.
- Round off industry analysis with competition. You must have a good idea of how crowded the market is, who the leaders are and what their moats are in relation the company going public.

Head to 'our business' section next. Focus more on understanding what contributes to revenue (share of key product lines and their margin profile, geography/ customers contribution to revenue) with the help of quantitative data presented. Hunt for factors that give a competitive advantage to the company. They could be IP rights, distribution network or the company's entrenched position in a capital-intensive market. Further, use the 'strategies' section to understand how the company intends to pursue growth (organic/ inorganic). Also, do not miss the data on capacity utilisation of manufacturing units. If they are close to being fully utilised, it can give you useful perspective when modelling free cash flows, as there could be capex requirements in the near term.

RATIO ANALYSIS

- **Cash flow from operations (before tax) to EBITDA** - suggests the extent of operating profit converted to cash. There is no clear benchmark but as a rule of thumb, a ratio above 75 per cent is considered fine. It is very important to check whether earnings are concurrent with increase in cash flows. If not, the company's working capital could be dragging cash flows down. Look if it is temporary or can be justified, given the nature of the industry
- **Net debt-to-equity ratio** - measures a company's leverage. Net debt = Borrowings (non-current and current) - cash and bank balances - liquid investments (like short-term mutual funds). Lower the ratio, the better it is and the benchmark depends on the capital intensity of the industry (infer from ratios of peers). In general, a ratio below 1x is desirable.
- **Current ratio** - measured by dividing current assets by current liabilities, gives you an idea whether the company is solvent in the short-term. This must be 1x at the least. However, some businesses such as retail, which collect cash from customers immediately on sale and pay vendors later, may have negative working capital or current ratio below 1x.
- **Fixed assets turnover ratio** - measured by dividing revenue by fixed assets, suggests how often the company can turn the investment in fixed assets into revenue. Higher ratio, the better it is. Calculating this ratio is essential especially when a company is raising capital for capex. Read along with the schedule of utilisation of issue proceeds given under 'objects of the offer' (relates to in which year the capex will be incurred), it should come handy in modelling future revenue.

VALUATION

With valuation being the only other major step left in the analysis, the 'basis for offer price' segment comes in handy if you belong to the school of relative valuation. The segment contains a detailed table comparing the KPIs of the company like RoCE, working capital days, margins and growth rates with those of its listed peers. Once you triangulate the closest peer and its valuation multiple (P/E or P/B or EV/revenue), you can then add a valuation premium/ discount depending on the company's growth prospects and competitive advantages relative to the closest peer. This can help you judge whether the company's offer price makes it undervalued or overvalued, relative to its peers.

For example, readers may recall our 'avoid' call on HDB Financial Services' IPO (June 26, 2025) at 3.4x book value. We had based our call on two factors. One, although the risk profile of HDB's loan book is lower than that of Bajaj Finance's (P/B of 6x then), its credit cost was similar to Bajaj's. Ideally, HDB's credit cost should've been lower. Two, its parent HDFC Bank, which had an RoA similar to HDB and a credit cost much lower than HDB, was trading at a lower valuation. In our view, from a long-term perspective, there was no attractive case to be made for subscribing to its IPO, given other listed options at that time. HDB trades below its IPO price today.

Investors must also remember that in some cases, relying on relative valuation comes with the risk of comparison with overvalued peers. Readers can recall our 'avoid' call on Hexaware Technologies' IPO (edition dated February 9, 2025), although its IPO valuation was cheaper than listed peers. In this case, we had pointed out that in the face of uncertainty caused by AI, mid-cap IT services stocks were being mispriced and Hexaware was expensive on an absolute basis as well. Today, multiples of Hexaware's peers (Persistent, Coforge) have been substantially derated from over 70x then to about 45x now. Our 'avoid' call on Hexaware, based on its then-absolute P/E of 41x, relative to growth prospects has been validated. The stock now trades 25 per cent below its issue price.

Finally, to round off the analysis, head to the 'capital structure' segment. Find out if there are instances of primary issues of capital within a range of 2 years preceding the IPO, at prices that look significantly at a discount, relative to the issue price of the IPO. This analysis is even more relevant for IPOs with only the OFS component. This is to see if recent investors are looking to exit with quick, big gains.

Assess if the premium valuation is justified by comparing the returns delivered by listed peers over the same period. In the recent case of Dhoot Transmission (edition dated August 9, 2026), the issue price of ₹871 was higher than Bain Capital's cost of shares acquired since April 2025 at ₹480 (an 81-per cent premium). However, given stocks of some peers had gained up to 76 per cent in the same period made the issue price appear justified.

THERE'S ALWAYS A SECOND CHANCE

We would also like to remind our readers of our earlier Big Story (edition dated December 14, 2025) that carried an in-depth analysis of IPOs during 2021-25. We had highlighted how 65-75 per cent of IPOs tend to fall 20-50 per cent from their issue prices to their all-time lows within two years of listing. If your analysis suggests that valuations do not add up given the underlying fundamentals, wait for your second chance. On the other hand, once subscribed for the long-term, remain unfazed by interim stock volatility, provided the thesis remains intact.

■
Hrishikesh Dasarthy

Stock options are now a standard part of the pay package across India's technology, financial services and professional sectors. Their tax treatment remains among the least understood areas of personal taxation for a simple reason — an ESOP (employee stock option plan) is taxed twice, at two separate moments, under two different heads of income, and the first of those moments usually arrives before the employee has seen any cash. What follows is a walk through the rules as they currently stand.

Sections are cited from the Income-Tax Act, 2025, in force from April 1, 2026, with the corresponding provision of the 1961 Act in brackets. The two numbering systems collide in places, so the brackets matter: For instance, Section 197 of the new Act is the long-term capital gains charge, while Section 197 of the old Act was the lower-withholding certificate.

When is an ESOP taxed?
An option passes through four stages. It is granted, it vests, it is exercised and the resulting share is eventually sold. Only the last two attract tax.

Tax arises at two points. On exercise, the benefit is charged as salary, in the form of a perquisite. On sale, the further appreciation is charged as capital gains. The two charges are separate, they fall in different years more often than not, and they are computed on different bases.

How is the taxable value of perquisite computed on exercise?

Section 17 of the Income-Tax Act, 2025 (Section 17(2) (vi) of the 1961 Act) treats the difference between the fair market value of the share and the price the employee actually paid as a taxable perquisite (Perquisite = Fair market value on the date of exercise – Exercise price paid). Determination of fair market value (FMV) is not left to the employer's discretion. For a listed company, the FMV is the average of the opening and closing price of the share on a recognised stock exchange on the date of exercise. For an unlisted company, it must be certified by a Category I Merchant Banker, and the certificate must be dated within 180 days of the exercise date. These were rules 3(8) and 3(9) of the 1962 Rules, now carried into rules 15(6) and 15(7) of the Income-Tax Rules, 2026.

An illustration will be used throughout this piece. An



ESOPs and the taxman

DE-TAX. A ready reckoner on how employee stock options are taxed in India, from exercise to exit

GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

employee holds 1,000 options at an exercise price of ₹100. On the date she exercises, the FMV is ₹500. Her perquisite is ₹400 a share, or ₹4 lakh. That sum is added to her salary and taxed at her slab rate. Her employer must deduct tax on it under Section 392 (Section 192) and report it in Form 123 (Form 12BA) and Form 130 (Form 16).

She has not sold anything at this stage. Where does the money to pay that tax come from?

Nowhere — and that is the difficulty. She has already paid ₹1 lakh to acquire the shares and now owes tax on a further ₹4 lakh that exists only on paper. Practitioners call this the “dry tax” problem. In an unlisted company, it is sharper still since the valuation driving the tax is itself an estimate, and the shares may not be saleable at any price for years.

Relief is available, though narrowly. Employees of start-ups recognised by the DPIIT and eligible under Section 140 (Section 80-IAC) may have the employer's withholding (TDS) deferred, under Section 392(3) (Section 192(1C)). The tax falls due within 14 days of the earliest of three events:

* The expiry of 48 months from the end of the relevant assessment year or roughly five years from allotment;

TAKE NOTE

- ESOPs are taxed at exercise and sale
- Exercise-date FMV becomes cost of acquisition for capital gains
- Holding period starts from share allotment date

- * The date the shares are sold; or
- * The date the employee leaves.

Note what the deferral does and does not do. It postpones collection. The charge itself still crystallises on the date of exercise, at that year's slab rates, and the liability does not shrink while it waits.

How is the capital gain computed when the shares are sold?

This is where the most expensive errors occur, and there are almost always errors in the cost of acquisition.

The cost is not the exercise price the employee paid. Under Section 73(1) (Section 49(2AA)), where an FMV has already been taxed as a perquisite, that same FMV becomes the cost of acquisition. The reasoning is simply that the gap between the exercise price and the exercise-date FMV has been taxed once already, as salary,

and taxing it a second time on sale would be double taxation.

Capital gain = Sale consideration – FMV on the date of exercise – Expenses of transfer

Continuing the illustration, she sells all 1,000 shares at ₹900. Sale consideration is ₹9 lakh. Her cost is ₹5 lakh, being the exercise-date FMV of ₹500, not the ₹100 she paid. The capital gain is ₹4 lakh.

An employee who takes ₹1 lakh as her cost instead would declare a gain of ₹8 lakh and pay tax twice on the same ₹4 lakh. On a large exit, the mistake runs into lakhs, and it is common.

What is the rate of tax applicable on the capital gain?

Two variables decide it: Whether the share is listed, and how long it was held.

On listed equity shares where STT (securities transaction tax) has been paid, a short-term gain is taxed at 20 per cent under Section 196 (Section 111A).

A long-term gain is taxed at 12.5 per cent under Section 198 (Section 112A), on the amount above ₹1.25 lakh in the financial year.

On unlisted shares, a short-term gain is taxed at slab rates, which can reach up to 30 per cent before surcharge and cess, while a long-term gain is taxed at 12.5 per cent under Section 197 (Section 112).

Indexation is not available in either case.

Surcharge widens the gap further and is often overlooked. On salary income (ESOP perquisite), it can rise to 25 per cent under the default/new regime. On capital gains from listed shares, it is capped at 15 per cent.

From which date is the holding period counted — the exercise date or the allotment date?

From the date of allotment. The holding period of a capital asset can only begin once the asset exists, and the share comes into existence in the employee's hands when it is allotted and credited to her demat account or entered in the register of members.

Counted from that date, a listed equity share becomes long-term once it has been held for more than 12 months. An unlisted share needs more than 24 months. Anything shorter is short term.

An employee selling anywhere near the long-term threshold should take the date from her demat state-

ment rather than assume it matches the exercise date.

The two dates do different jobs, and it is worth keeping them apart. The exercise date fixes the perquisite value and, through it, the cost of acquisition. The allotment date starts the holding-period clock.

When is tax deducted at source?

Many assume withholding happens once, at exercise, and that the sale proceeds reach them net of tax.

At exercise, the employer withholds tax under Section 392 (Section 192) as part of salary and reports in Form 123 (Form 12BA) and Form 130 (Form 16). Eligible start-ups may defer this.

At sale, it depends on the route. On an ordinary secondary sale between two residents, and on a resident-to-resident tender offer, there is generally no withholding at all. The seller must estimate her own liability and pay advance tax, and failing to do so is what produces interest under Sections 424 and 425 (Sections 234B and 234C) at assessment.

Where the seller is a non-resident, Section 393(2) (Section 195) places a withholding obligation on the payer, subject to relief under the applicable tax treaty. A nil or lower deduction certificate is applied for under Section 395 (Section 197). This has become a live issue as employees often exercise in India and sell after moving abroad.

Residential status also shapes the charge itself. A resident and ordinarily resident employee is taxed on global income, including gains on options in a foreign parent. A non-resident or a resident but not ordinarily resident is taxed only on the portion attributable to services rendered in India, an apportionment that gets complicated where the vesting period straddles more than one country.

Given the rate difference, what does sensible planning look like on the sale side?

The arithmetic is worth running before any sale, because on the same gain, it produces materially different outcomes.

Take our employee's gain of ₹4 lakh. If the shares are listed and she sells within 12 months, she pays ₹80,000 (4

lakh x 20 per cent). Past 12 months, she pays 12.5 per cent on ₹2.75 lakh (after the ₹1.25-lakh exemption), or ₹34,375. If the shares are unlisted and she is in the 30 per cent bracket, selling within 24 months costs ₹1.2 lakh (4 lakh x 30 per cent) against ₹50,000 (4 lakh x 12.5 per cent) after. Crossing the line is, therefore, worth ₹45,625 on the listed holding and ₹70,000 on the unlisted one.

A few practical points follow.

One, where a liquidity event is being planned (in case of unlisted shares), scheduling the tender, buy-back or sale just past the 24-month mark, counted from allotment, converts slab-rate income into concessionally taxed gain.

Two, splitting sales across financial years allows the ₹1.25-lakh long-term exemption (only on listed shares) to be used more than once and keeps gains out of the higher surcharge bands.

Three, exercising early, while the FMV is low, pushes more of the eventual upside into the capital gains bucket and out of the salary bucket, though it has to be set against the dry-tax outflow

and the possibility that the shares never become liquid.

Four, capital losses from other assets can be set off against ESOP capital gains in the same year.

Finally, start-up employees who use the deferral should earmark the cash, because the bill does arrive.

Here's something important. Tax is an input, not the objective. Illiquidity, further dilution, concentration risk and the plain possibility of the company being worth less later have cost employees far more than the rate differential has ever saved them. Waiting three months to cross a threshold is usually sound. Waiting 18 months in an illiquid stock for the same reason often is not.

A documentation point is worth noting. Employees should obtain and keep the merchant banker valuation certificate for every exercise. Years later, it is the only evidence of the cost of acquisition, and reconstructing it after the employee has left and the company has changed hands is difficult.

The author is a Partner at Venkatesh & Co. Chartered Accountants. With inputs from Desikan Govindarajan

VAMA INDUSTRIES LIMITED
CIN: L72200TG1985PLC041126
Regd. Office: 7-1-24/2/D, 1st Floor, Greendale, Ammerpet, Hyderabad-500016, Telangana, India. Email: cs@vamaind.com. E-mail: cs@vamaind.com

NOTICE
NOTICE is hereby given that the 41st Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Company is scheduled to be held on Wednesday, 30th day of September, 2026 at 04:00 P.M. through Video Conferencing (VC)/Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM), in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations") and in accordance with General Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 20/2020 dated May 5, 2020, 10/2022 dated December 28, 2022, 09/2023 dated September 25, 2023, 09/2024 dated September 19, 2024 and 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs read with relevant circulars issued by the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"), from time to time in this regard, to transact such items of business as set out in the notice calling the said AGM.
In compliance with the above-mentioned circulars, the Notice of 41st AGM along with the Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 will be sent to all the shareholders of the Company through electronic mode, whose email addresses are registered with the Company or Company's Registrars & Share Transfer Agents (RTA) Depository Participants. The AGM Notice and the Annual Report will also be uploaded on our corporate website – www.vamaind.com, website of stock exchange, www.bseindia.com and on the website of CDSL – www.cdslindia.com.
Additionally, in accordance with Regulation 36(1)(b) of the Listing Regulations, the Company will be sending a letter to members whose e-mail address is not registered with Company/ Depository Participant providing the exact web-link of Company's website from where the Annual Report for financial year 2025-26 can be accessed.
To receive the notice of the said AGM, e-voting instructions and further communications, the Shareholders holding shares in physical mode, who have not registered/updated their email addresses with the Company can get the same registered with the Company by furnishing the duly filled and signed Form ISR-1 along with their Self attested PAN & Aadhaar to the Company's Registrars and Share Transfer Agents (RTA), M/s. Bigshare Services Private Limited., 306, Right Wing, Anantha Vile City, Yashoda Hospital, Somajiguda, Raj Bhavan Road, Hyderabad-500082. Email id: bssvtd@bigshareonline.com, and the shareholders holding shares in dematerialized mode are requested to register/update their email addresses with their Depository Participants.
Further, members may contact Mr. Pankaj Dadich, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer of the Company for any matter connected with receipt of Notice and Annual Report by writing an e-mail to an email id: cs@vamaind.com
Note: Links to download the KYC & Nomination Forms are mentioned below:
Form ISR-1: https://bigshareonline.com/docs/Form_ISR-1_REQUEST_FOR_REGISTERING_PAN_KYC_DETAILS_OR_CHANGES_UPDATE.pdf
Form ISR-2: https://bigshareonline.com/docs/Form_ISR-2_Confirmation_of_Signature_of_security_holder_by_the_Banker.pdf
Form ISR-3: https://bigshareonline.com/docs/Form_ISR-3_Declaration_Form_for_Opting-out_of_Nomination.pdf
Form SH-13: https://bigshareonline.com/docs/Form_NO_SH-13_Nomination_Form.pdf

By order of the Board
Sd/-
V. Atchutya Rama Raju
Managing Director
DIN:00997493

Place: Hyderabad
Date: 02-09-2026

CHAMAN METALICS LIMITED
Registered Office: A-26, M.I.D.C., Tadali Growth Centre, Tadali, Chandrapur (M.H.) 424246
Corporate Office: "GR House" Kharsa No. 1501/3, Ananta, Lahandhih, Krishak Nagar, Raipur (C.G.) 492012. Contact No.: 0771-4259100
Email: cs@cmilgroup.com Website: www.cmilgroup.com
CIN: L27100MH2003PLC143049

PUBLIC NOTICE OF 23rd ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given that:
1. The 23rd Annual General Meeting (AGM or Meeting) of Chaman Metalics Limited (the Company) will be held on Wednesday, 30th day of September, 2026 at 04:00 P.M. (IST) through Video conferencing (VC)/Other Audio-Visual Means (OAVM) facilitated by National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice convening the AGM. In compliance with all applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2023 (the "Act"), Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated April 08, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 20/2020 dated May 05, 2020 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard by MCA, the latest being 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 (collectively referred to as "MCA Circulars" and Pursuant to Regulation 36(3) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (SEBI LODR), the Company has sent the Notice of the 23rd AGM of the Company along with a weblink to access the Annual Report for the FY 2025-26 (Annual Report), on Friday, 04th September, 2026, through electronic mode only, to those Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company/Registrars and Transfer Agent (RTA) – MUFG Intime India Private Limited/Depositories/Depository Participants.
2. The Notice of the AGM along with the Annual Report for the Financial Year 2025-26 is available on the Company's website at www.cseindia.com, the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com and the website of National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) at www.nseindia.com. Comprehensive guidance on (a) remote e-Voting before the meeting, (b) participation in and joining of the Meeting through VC/OAVM, (c) e-Voting during the Meeting, and (d) registration of email IDs are available in the Notice of the AGM.
3. Remote E-Voting: In compliance with Section 108 of the Act read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, Regulation 44 of SEBI LODR, read with other applicable circulars of MCA/SEBI, the Company is providing to its Members the facility of remote e-Voting before the AGM as well as e-Voting during the AGM in respect of the business to be transacted as mentioned in the AGM Notice and for this purpose, the Company has appointed NSDL to facilitate voting through electronic means. The detailed instructions for remote e-Voting are given in the Notice convening the AGM. Members are requested to take note of the following:

- The remote e-Voting facility shall commence on Sunday, 27th September, 2026 at 09:00 A.M. (IST) and shall end on Tuesday, 28th September, 2026 at 05:00 P.M. (IST). The remote e-Voting module will be disabled by NSDL for voting thereafter and Members will not be allowed to vote electronically through remote e-Voting beyond the said date and time. b. The voting rights of the Members shall be in proportion to their share of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on Wednesday, 23rd September, 2026 ("Cut-Off Date").** Members will be provided with the facility for voting through electronic voting system during the VC/OAVM proceedings at the AGM and Members participating at the AGM, who have not updated their email IDs, will be able to vote on resolution(s) by remote e-Voting will be eligible to exercise their right to vote on such resolution(s) upon announcement by the Chairman. Members who have cast their vote on resolution(s) by remote e-Voting prior to the AGM will also be eligible to participate at the AGM through VC/OAVM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote on such resolution(s) again. The remote e-Voting module on the day of the AGM shall be disabled by NSDL for voting 15 minutes after the conclusion of the Meeting. c. Any shareholder(s) who acquires shares of the Company and becomes a Member of the Company after dispatch of the Notice and holding shares as on the Cut-Off Date i.e. Wednesday, 23rd September, 2026, may obtain the User ID and Password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com. However, if a person is already registered with NSDL for remote e-Voting then the Member can use their existing User ID and password for casting the vote. d. A person who is not a member as on the cut-off date should treat this Notice for information purpose only. A person whose name is recorded in the register of members or in the register of beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on the cut-off date, only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-Voting before the AGM as well as e-Voting during the AGM. In case of any queries/grievances relating to e-voting, the members/beneficial owners may, may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions ("FAQs") for Shareholders and e-Voting user manual for Shareholders available in the "Download" section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call at 022-4886 7000 or send a request at evoting@nsdl.com or contact Mr. Amit Vishal, Assistant Vice President or Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Senior Manager, NSDL, at the designated Email ID: amv@nsdl.com or pallavi@nsdl.com. The address of NSDL is Plot C-1 Block G, Exchange Plaza, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400015. f. Shareholders holding securities in Demat mode for any technical issues related to login/exit through depositories (A) Members holding securities with NSDL can contact NSDL helpline by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com or contact at 022 - 4886 7000. (B) Members holding securities with CDSL can contact CDSL helpline by sending a request at helpline.evoting@cdslindia.com or contact at 1800-21-09931.
- For Chaman Metalics Limited**
Sd/-
K. RANJAN RAHM,
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

ALERTS.

IRDAI flags fake insurance grievance portal



The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) has cautioned policyholders and other stakeholders against a website allegedly posing as an IRDAI-related insurance grievance and complaint registration platform. It said igmsirdai.online, including its complaint registration page, is not an official IRDAI website.

Axis Bank, Scapia launch no-fee travel credit card



Axis Bank and travel fintech Scapia have launched a co-branded credit card for digitally native travellers, offering zero foreign exchange margin, airport privileges and rewards on travel and everyday spending, with no joining or annual fee. The Scapia Axis Bank Credit Card offers up to 20 per cent rewards on eligible travel bookings and up to 10 per cent on other eligible spends through the Scapia app.

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KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice
Tender No: 01/2026-27/SE/PHC/ALP
State Plan - State Plan 2026-2027 Optimization of Production and Transmission - providing drinking water facilities in Thuravoor and Kuthiyathode Panchayath, Aror Constituency. - Pipeline Work. EMD: Rs. 1,00,000, Tender fee : Rs. 8270+(1489 GST at 18%), Last Date for submitting Tender : 22-09-2026, 02:00 pm, Phone : 04772237954
Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in, www.etenders.kerala.gov.in
Superintending Engineer
PH circle, Alappuzha

AXISCADES Technologies Limited
CIN: L72200KA1990PLC084435
Regd Address: Block C, 2nd Floor, Kirtoskar Business Park, Bengaluru-560024, Karnataka, India.
Tel: + 91 80 4193 9000 Fax: + 91 80 4193 9099 Email: secretary@axiscades.in, Website: <https://axiscades.com/>

NOTICE OF 36TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND E-VOTING INFORMATION
Notice is hereby given that the Thirty Sixth (36th) Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of the Company will be convened on Monday, September 28, 2026 at 10:30 AM (IST) by way of Video Conference ("VC") / Other Audio-Visual Means ("OAVM") without physical presence of members at common venue, to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice of AGM. Members will be able to attend the AGM through VC/OAVM only to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice of the AGM.
The Company has sent the Notice of AGM and Annual Report through e-mail to Members on September 05, 2026, whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company/RTA/Depository Participants in accordance with Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA").
Further, in accordance with Regulation 36(1)(b) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company has sent a letter to shareholders whose e-mail address are not registered with the Company / Registrar /DPs, providing the weblink to access the Annual Report 2025-26 of the Company.
Members may also note that the Notice of 36th AGM along with the explanatory statement and the Annual Report for the Financial Year 2025-26 is available on the Company's website at <https://axiscades.com/> and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and on the website of KFin Technologies Limited, Registrar and Transfer Agent ("KFin") at <https://evoting.kfintech.com/public/Downloads.aspx>
Members for joining the AGM are provided in the Notice of the AGM. Members attending the meeting through VC/OAVM shall be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013.
Since the AGM is being held pursuant to Circulars through VC/OAVM, the physical attendance of members has been dispensed with. Accordingly, the facility of appointment of proxies by the member will not be available for the AGM. In compliance with Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 as amended from time to time and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Members are provided with the facility to cast their votes on all resolutions set forth in the Notice of the AGM using remote electronic voting facility (remote e-voting) provided by Depositories and KFin. Additionally, the Company is providing the facility of voting through e-voting system during the AGM (e-voting). Detailed procedure for remote e-voting/e-voting are provided in the Notice of the AGM. All members are informed that:
1. The instructions for participating through VC/OAVM and the process of e-voting, including the manner in which Members holding shares in physical form or who have not registered their e-mail address can cast their vote through e-voting are provided as part of the Notice of the 36th AGM.
2. The Company will be providing VC/OAVM facility to enable the members to attend the AGM. Members who are entitled to participate in the AGM can attend the AGM or view the live webcast of AGM by logging on the website of KFin in at <https://emeetings.kfintech.com> by using their remote e-voting credentials.
3. Members whose name is recorded in the Register of Members / Beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on the cut-off date, which is Monday, September 21, 2026 only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting & e-voting at AGM.
4. The remote e-voting period will commence on Friday, September 25, 2026 at 9:00 A.M. (IST) and will end on Sunday, September 27, 2026 at 5:00 P.M. (IST). Members will not be able to cast their vote electronically as envisaged herein, beyond the date and time mentioned above.
5. Eligible Members who have acquired shares after the dispatch of Annual Report and holding shares as on the cut-off date i.e. Monday, September 21, 2026, may obtain the User ID and Password by following the procedures mentioned in the Notice.
6. Members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the AGM may attend the AGM through VC/OAVM, but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again. Members who have not cast their vote through remote e-voting and are present in the AGM through VC/OAVM, shall be eligible to vote through e-voting at the AGM.
7. The Company has appointed Mr. Pramod S. M. or failing him, Mr. Biswajit Ghosh of M/s. BMP & Co. LLP, Company Secretaries, Bengaluru as Scrutinizer to scrutinize the e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner.
8. Members who have not registered their email ids so far, are requested to register their email ids in respect of shares held in electronic form with the Depository through their Depository Participant(s) and in respect of shares held in physical form by writing to the Company's RTA viz., KFin Technologies Limited, Selenium Tower B, Plot Nos. 31 & 32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Gachibowli, Hyderabad 500 032.
9. In case of any query pertaining to e-voting, please visit Help & FAQs section available at KFin website (<https://evoting.kfintech.com/public/Faq.aspx>). In case of any other queries/ grievances connected to remote e-voting or shares, you may contact Mr. Raj Kumar Kale, an official of KFin, at telephone number: 040-67162222 or the toll free number 1800-309- 4001 or email: evoting@kfintech.com.

For **AXISCADES Technologies Limited**
Sd/- **Sonal Dudani**
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
Membership No.: A40415

Place: Bengaluru
Date: September 05, 2026

MEENAKSHI INDIA LIMITED
CIN : L74300TN1987PLC014678
Regd. Office : 29 / 16 Whites Road, IV Floor, Royapettah, Chennai - 600014
Phone:044-42636795, EMAIL ID: investor.relations@milgroup.in, www.milgroup.in

NOTICE OF 44TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, REMOTE E-VOTING AND BOOK CLOSURE
NOTICE is hereby given that the Forty-Fourth (44th) Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of Meenakshi India Limited ("the Company") is scheduled to be held on **Monday, September 28, 2026, at 12:00 noon (IST)** through Video Conferencing ("VC") / Other Audio-Visual Means ("OAVM"), to transact the business as set forth in the Notice of the AGM dated 31.08.2026. ("Notice").
The AGM will be conducted in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 (the "Act") and Rules made thereunder and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("SEBI Listing Regulations") read with General Circular No. 20/2020 dated May 5, 2020 and 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA Circulars") and other applicable circulars issued by MCA and SEBI from time to time.
Members are hereby informed that:
a. The Notice and Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 have been sent only through electronic mode to those Members only whose email addresses are registered with the Company/ Registrar and Share Transfer Agent ("RTA") or with their respective Depository Participant(s) ("DPs") as on Friday, August 28, 2026. The electronic dispatch of Notice and Annual Report has been completed on Saturday, September 05, 2026
b. In accordance with Regulation 36(1)(b) of the SEBI Listing Regulations, a letter containing the weblink, including the exact path, to access the Annual Report has also been dispatched to those Members whose email addresses are not registered with the Company, the RTA or the DPs.
c. The Notice and Annual Report are available on the websites of the Company at www.milgroup.in under Investors' section, BSE Limited ("BSE") at www.bseindia.com and The Calcutta Stock Exchange ("CSE") at www.cse-india.com and on the website of CDSL at <https://evoting.cdslindia.com>.
d. The Company has engaged CDSL to provide the facility for remote e-Voting before the AGM and e-Voting during the AGM. The Company's E-Voting Event Number is 260901013 ("EVSN").
e. The remote e-Voting facility will be available during the following period:

Commencement	Friday, September 25, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. (IST)
Conclusion	Sunday, September 27, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. (IST)

f. The remote e-Voting module will be disabled by CDSL upon expiry of the aforesaid period. Remote e-Voting will not be permitted thereafter. Once a Member has cast a vote on a resolution, the Member will not be permitted to change it subsequently.
g. A person whose name appears in the Register of Members or the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained with Depositories on Friday, September 18, 2026 ("Cut-Off Date") shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-Voting before the AGM and e-Voting during the AGM. A person who is not a member as on the Cut-Off Date should treat this Notice for information purposes only.
h. The voting rights of Members shall be in proportion to their shareholding in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the Cut-Off Date.
i. Any person holding shares in physical mode or who acquires shares and becomes a member of the Company after dispatch of the Notice, and holds shares as of the Cut-Off Date, may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request to helpline.evoting@cdslindia.com or the Company at investor.relations@milgroup.in and/or RTA. However, a member already registered with CDSL for e-Voting may use the existing User ID and password for casting the vote.
j. The Company has appointed Shri. JAGDISH PRASAD MUNDHARA, (ICSI Membership No. FCS 2353), Proprietor, M/s. Mundhara & Co. Practicing Company Secretaries as scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-voting before and during the AGM in a fair and transparent manner.
k. The Register of Members and the Share Transfer Books of the Company will remain closed for the period of **44th AGM, Tuesday, September 22, 2026 to Monday, September 28, 2026 (both days inclusive)** for the purpose of 44th AGM.
l. The relevant documents relating to the businesses to be transacted at the AGM will be available for electronic inspection in the manner specified in the Notice.
m. The voting results of the AGM along with the report of the Scrutinizer shall be declared within the prescribed statutory timelines and will be placed on the website of the Company, Stock Exchanges and CDSL.
n. For any query / clarification or issues regarding E-Voting/E-Voting during the AGM, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) and e-voting manual available at www.evotingindia.com, under help section or write an email to helpline.evoting@cdslindia.com or contact Mr. Rakesh Dalvi (Senior Manager) on tollfree No. 18

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Bajaj Mutual Fund, one of the newer entrants in India's crowded MF industry, has shown early promise with key offerings doing well and its assets under management nearing the ₹40,000-crore mark. At its September market symposium in Mumbai, *bl.portfolio* spoke to Nimesh Chandan, Chief Investment Officer, about valuations, foreign flows, earnings, market-cap opportunities and popular themes.

Edited excerpts:

Are valuations beginning to matter more as global liquidity tightens? Could they fall towards pre-Covid levels?

Recently, because of volatility, there has been a huge divergence in valuations across sectors.

For example, if you look at financials, valuations are probably at decade-low levels. If you look at some capital goods companies in areas such as data centres, AI or the power sector, valuations have moved up very substantially. In this kind of market, rather than generalising about a category or the overall benchmark, one must look on a bottom-up basis for opportunities or pockets where growth is good but valuations are lower.

So, it is an active stock-picker's market right now. Interest rates could possibly move up from here. But if interest rates move up because growth is surprisingly positive, valuations will adjust upwards. If interest rates go up purely because of cost-push inflation, it is likely that valuations will come under pressure.

With global yields surging, what would bring FPIs back to India?

Most of the time, global investors as well as domestic investors look for stronger growth and lower valuations. Over the last two years, in many pockets, we saw earnings downgrades, growth coming under pressure and geopolitical issues creating uncertainty.

Now, we are affected by oil prices because of the crisis in West Asia.

What we have seen slowly this year is that uncertainty is receding. That is why we have seen some foreign investors coming back — growth is improving, valuations in some pockets are becoming attractive, and that is bringing money back. Yet, no matter how much you analyse, you cannot say that a particular flow of liquidity will continue or reverse again.

However, conditions generally are right for attracting foreign flows back into the country.

Are investors underplaying geopolitical risks?

This time, people are actually well aware of the geopolitical issues and, frankly, a bit fearful too. That is now reflecting in volatility and some profit-book-ing every time markets start moving up. Fear is a difficult emotion to control and does drive decision-making.

Wars typically get people worried and scared, and that is

‘Growth is improving’

MEET THE CIO. Nimesh Chandan of Bajaj Mutual Fund on what the market may be mispricing and what could change the AMC’s stance on key sectors



PROFILE

Nimesh Chandan is Chief Investment Officer at Bajaj Asset Management. He has 22 years of experience investing in Indian capital markets, including 17 years in the MF industry. He has managed products across market capitalisations and themes, and developed models in sustainable investing, quant investing and asset allocation.

playing out. So, I wouldn't say people are underestimating the impact. Possibly, in some areas, people are overestimating the impact or assuming that this will go on for much longer.

You say the market is modestly undervalued but also advise investors to stagger investments over months. Why?

We typically tell investors to look at equities from at least a three- to five-year perspective. The longer, the better; perhaps even a decade or two when you are investing in mutual funds and diversified mutual funds. However, it is possible that many investors get disturbed by volatility and the news flow coming in.

The last two to three months have been more volatile since the conflict began in March. There has been greater volatility in global as well as domestic markets, which may unnerv certain investors. That's when we recommend that SIPs are better — not only because of the rupee-cost averaging they offer, but also because they are psychologically more comfortable for investors and may prevent them from redeeming at the wrong time out of fear.

Coming to sectors, what is the market currently mispricing?

It looks like India will see a manufacturing resurgence, especially led by exports. A lot of MNCs as well as large domestic manufacturing companies are increasing their capex. I think the market is underestimating the kind of growth we will get in manufactured exports and in manufacturing sectors overall in India.

It could be capital goods, textiles, automobiles, auto ancillaries, or newer areas such as physical AI or robotics, and supplying certain equipment to data centres. People seem to be underestimating many of these, though not all. Many of these opportunities may be underestimated because we now have a currency advantage, trade agreements in place and the capex cycle is doing well.

Where is earnings recovery actually visible?

In the latest quarterly results, we looked at certain metrics

that we track internally, including how many companies are meeting or beating estimates. We track about 400 companies and found that 75 per cent of them have either met or exceeded expectations, while only about 25 per cent have missed expectations. The proportion of companies meeting or beating expectations was much lower, say, six quarters ago. That gives us confidence that the earnings trajectory is now looking up. Analyst forecasts for Nifty earnings are also pointing to higher earnings growth in FY27 and FY28. That gives us confidence that we are on an uptick in terms of the earnings growth rate.

Which sectors have moved from green shoots to a strong upcycle?

The biggest change has come from all the efforts the government took in terms of income-tax cuts and GST cuts, while interest rates have also come down since the beginning of 2025. The wealth effect from the rise in gold prices is also showing up in higher discretionary spending and consumption. Most companies in the consumption space have given a positive outlook or spoken about a recovery in growth for the rest of FY27 and, in some cases, FY28 as well.

This is the biggest change we have seen. Despite high inflation, uncertainty and domestic petrol and diesel prices being revised upwards, demand in many of these sectors has remained strong and companies have a positive outlook for the year.

Where are prices running ahead of fundamentals?

Every time people get attracted

towards a theme, they start giving it a higher valuation. That reflects their higher expectations or the longevity of growth they are expecting. While I can't say that an entire sector or theme is getting overpriced or underpriced, there are pockets within defence, some power equipment companies or some AI-related plays where we have seen valuations move up substantially. That does not mean they will come down tomorrow, but they become vulnerable to any negative news flow that may emerge.

You said you like both large-caps and small-caps. Why?

We like both the large-cap and small-cap spaces, but for different reasons. We like large-caps because of valuations and small-caps because of growth. These are the two areas where we are able to hunt for ideas and are likely to find better opportunities.

In large-caps, however, because there are only 100 companies to choose from, we typically run concentrated positions. You will find that we typically invest in about 30 companies out of those 100. In small-caps, we run a larger portfolio because the universe itself is much larger.

At last count, we were choosing from about 900 companies in the small-cap space and have created a portfolio of about 95 companies in our small-cap portfolio. So, in a way, we are choosing one out of every 10 companies. But because the universe is so large, we are able to find 95 companies that qualify on the quality, growth and value mix.

So, are you more cautious on mid-caps?

Yes. Of the three categories, the one that has done extremely well and was the first to hit an all-time high was the mid-cap category. We are not negative on mid-cap businesses, but when a category becomes very highly valued, we become a little cautious and very selective. Even in our flexi-cap and multi-cap funds, we have mid-cap allocations, but we are extremely selective. It is a 150-company space that we have to select from. If the whole category has been a leader in terms of re-

turns, we have to be a little careful about where valuations have become very high or certain businesses within that category have become highly priced. Ideally, what a fund manager tries to do is give you the best growth and the best value so that you get higher compounding.

Even if you pick a good company at a high valuation, you may not get good compounding. That is the only reason why we have not launched a dedicated mid-cap fund yet.

You have been underweight on the IT sector. What would make you reverse your stance?

If there is a pickup in earnings growth, we will change our stance. Within IT, large-cap, mid-cap and small-cap companies have very different ranges of growth and valuations, depending on their growth rates. Generally, IT is a more top-down sector. If there is buoyancy in the sector, you will see upgrades in earnings growth across large-caps, mid-caps as well as small-caps. At that time, we will choose whichever companies we like from that space. But currently, we don't see scope for earnings growth, at least for this year.

Private-sector banks have been a consensus buy call. How do you see them?

Our position has been that we were underweight on the large private banks and overweight on the mid-cap and small-cap private banks. Many of them had good capital, displayed good loan growth and maintained very good asset quality. Their valuations were also attractive.

So, we had invested more in those. But after the kind of correction we have seen in many of the large banks now, they have become attractive. There are some management changes, so some uncertainty still remains.

Investors are just waiting for clarity on the top management at some of these banks. Once that comes, the stocks are likely to move. So, we are now turning more positive towards these private banks. Also, many private banks may actually benefit from rising rates because they can pass them on through their asset pricing, while liabilities get repriced more slowly.

ALERTS.

Helios MF crosses ₹15,000-crore AUM

Samir Arora-founded boutique equity-focused Helios Mutual Fund's assets under management (AUM) crossed the ₹15,000-crore mark, registering a growth of 200 per cent compared to the previous year (August 2025). This milestone was achieved within three years of the launch of its first equity scheme in November 2023, according to the fund house. Equity-oriented schemes constitute the largest share of the fund house's assets with an AUM of about ₹14,356 crore, accounting for over 95 per cent of the total AUM. Hybrid schemes and debt-oriented schemes contribute about ₹425 crore and ₹285 crore, respectively.



ICICI Pru Dynamic Asset Allocation FoF NFO

ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has launched the ICICI Prudential Dynamic Asset Allocation Passive FoF, an open-ended fund of funds scheme investing dynamically in units of passive equity and debt-oriented schemes. Equity-debt allocation is guided by an in-house Equity Valuation Index. The NFO closes September 9. Minimum application amount/switch-in during the NFO is ₹1,000, and in multiples of ₹1. Fund Managers are Manan Tijoriwala, Sharmila D'Silva, Manish Banthia, Ritesh Lunawat, and Nishit Patel. The fund's benchmark is CRISIL Hybrid 50+50 – Moderate Index.



ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
as on Sep 4				
ETF				
ICICI Prudential Oil&Gas ETF	11.4	11.4	1.2	10,198
Groww Nifty PSE ETF	97.9	98.3	1.2	19
CPSE ETF	93.8	93.7	1.0	3,958
Motilal Oswal 5Yr G Sec-ETF	65.4	65.7	0.9	1,627
Tata Nifty Pvt Bank ETF	288.7	290.3	0.8	3
Kotak Nifty Pvt Bank ETF	27.9	28.0	0.8	232
Groww Nifty Realty ETF	10.2	10.2	0.7	1,374
GOLD ETFs				
LIC MF Gold ETF	138.4	138.8	-2.3	826
Angel One Gold ETF	14.2	14.4	-2.4	2,777
Bandhan Gold ETF	153.4	153.8	-2.6	47

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on September 4, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR					
Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Sep 4	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	53.8	10.4	9.3	12.4	83,530
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	74.4	11.5	10.4	12.4	31,712
Kotak Pension Fund	67.4	10.6	10.0	12.2	4,858
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	31.4	6.7	6.0	7.7	9,264
SBI Pension Fund	42.0	6.7	6.0	7.2	31,312
HDFC Pension Fund	28.8	6.4	5.7	7.1	56,674
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.9	7.8	6.8	7.9	36,261
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	46.6	7.7	6.6	7.7	14,635
SBI Pension Fund	46.7	7.7	6.6	7.7	16,480
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	46.8	10.6	9.5	12.5	1,921
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	58.6	11.2	10.3	12.4	852
Kotak Pension Fund	59.3	10.6	10.0	12.2	233

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on September 4, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns					
AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	364	14.9	20.6	24.1
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE Bluechip	5	8.7	17.9	16.8
ICICI Pru	Largecap	905	7.5	17.6	15.5
Ksema Wealth	Alpha	16	6.3	12.5	13.8
MULTI CAP					
New Berry Capitals	Seeking Alpha	9	14.9	17.5	32.9
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	8,686	15.3	33.8	24.0
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	121	10.2	24.3	23.4
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	483	8.3	20.6	22.2
Systematix Shares And Stock (I)	Dynamic Investment	NA	18.2	23.6	20.4
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,180	10.6	18.2	20.1
MID-CAP					
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	12.2	14.0	17.1
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	35.6	21.9	15.5
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	9.8	16.3	15.1
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-4.4	11.3	14.9
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	2,319	30.1	28.5	29.6
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	1,026	4.0	20.0	28.2
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,533	-4.5	22.0	21.1
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	248	16.8	19.0	20.1

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on July 31, 2026

Big money managers rebuild gold positions

GLOBAL VIEW. Central banks’ buying, diversification demand and dollar concerns reinforce bullion’s appeal as a hedge

Bloomberg

Some of the world's biggest money managers have rebuilt their gold holdings after the recent price retreat, betting that the precious metal's long-term drivers will endure even as the US Federal Reserve takes a more assertive stance on inflation. Amundi SA, Europe's largest asset manager, bought bullion on expectations that prices will return to \$5,000 an ounce by year-end. Fund managers at Pictet Asset Management Ltd, Robeco Institutional Asset Management BV and Fidelity International Ltd have also rebuilt positions cut earlier this year during gold's retreat from an all-time high.

"Gold is an asset that we consider to be cheap, a good hedge and reasonably liquid," said Lorenzo Portelli, head of cross-asset strategy at the Amundi Investment Institute. However, greater visibility on the Fed's interest-rate path would be needed before the firm considers adding to last month's purchases, he said.

That was a common theme in interviews with more than a dozen asset managers, whose

firms collectively manage \$27 trillion. All had either added to gold holdings in recent weeks or maintained bullish allocations, including BNP Paribas Asset Management and Manulife John Hancock Investments.

FED HEADWINDS

Higher Treasury yields and growing bets on at least one Fed rate hike before year-end are weighing on bullion, which tends to lose appeal when borrowing costs rise because it does not pay interest.

Investors' resolve was tested by Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh's August 28 speech at the central bank's Jackson Hole symposium, where he warned that US inflation was not slowing meaningfully towards the 2 per cent target. His comments fuelled expectations of tighter monetary policy.

So far, these potential headwinds have not dented long-term investors' renewed conviction. Gold's enduring appeal, several money managers said, lies in its role as a hedge within a broader portfolio.

"It's become a much more acceptable asset," said Arnout van Rijn, portfolio manager for multi-asset and equity solutions



at Robeco, which oversees about \$464 billion.

BUYING THE DIP

After a blistering rally fuelled by speculative capital pushed gold to an all-time high near \$5,600 an ounce in January, the metal spent much of the year retreating. Elevated energy prices and inflationary shocks from the Iran war dragged it to around \$4,000 in June, prompting funds to step back in.

"The downdraft to \$4,000, if you didn't own it already, was a very good buying time," said Michael Cuggino, president of the Permanent Portfolio Family of

Funds. "The long-term macro story is still in place and that's bullish for gold," he said, adding that "higher highs and higher lows" could be expected over time. For Robeco's van Rijn, the catalyst for rebuilding gold positions was an acceleration in central-bank purchases in the second quarter. Official-sector demand recovered sharply, with net purchases of 289 tonnes — the highest for any second quarter — according to the World Gold Council.

HEDGE MAKES A RETURN Sophie Huynh, a portfolio manager and strategist for dynamic

Kumar Shankar Roy
Hari Viswanath
bl. research bureau

In July 2021, when IT services company Happiest Minds Technologies traded at ₹1,494.15, we at *bl.portfolio* had recommended that investors ‘book profits’. The company was executing well, but the stock had run up over eight times from its IPO price and was then valued at about 119 times FY22 earnings. At that time, we had mentioned that ‘such levels of valuation for Indian IT services companies were last witnessed only during the dotcom era and what followed then was not all that exciting.’ Our concern was that Happiest Minds, despite being almost entirely focussed on digital services, did not confer enough superiority over larger IT companies to justify such extraordinary valuations.

As of September 4, 2026, Happiest Minds was at ₹354.35 apiece, down 76.3 per cent since our book profit call. The stock now trades around 19x one-year forward P/E based on consensus estimates for FY2027.

After such a steep fall and valuation reset, is this the time to jump back in, especially after the proposed merger with ITC Infotech? The initial market reaction has been weak, with the stock falling nearly 13 per cent in just a few days from around ₹406 when the deal was announced on August 31.

Hence, we would still hold our horses. While the valuation froth has been purged over the past five years and Happiest Minds is no longer outrageously valued, it is not cheap enough to overlook the uncertainties surrounding its proposed merger with ITC Infotech, the transition to an ITC-controlled combined entity and its growth prospects amid AI-led disruptions.

Existing investors can hold and watch, while fresh investors need not rush in.

VALUATION RESET

Per Bloomberg, Happiest Minds trades at about 25 times current earnings (trailing 12 months) and nearly 19 times FY27 earnings. That is a world away from the three-digit P/E multiple of 2021. But cheaper does not automatically mean cheap.

At about 25 times trailing earnings, Happiest Minds is val-

Not yet the happiest time to buy

IT SERVICES. Happiest Minds’ merger with ITC Infotech improves scale, but valuation and transition risks warrant patience



From euphoria to reality

Happiest Minds stock price vs Nifty 50



Note: Our July 18, 2021 ‘book profits’ recommendation was based on Happiest Minds’ July 16, 2021 closing price; both series are rebased to 100 on that date

ued close to Mphasis and above Hexaware, HCL Technologies, TCS, Infosys, Sonata Software and Mastek. Persistent Systems and Coforge command much higher multiples, but also have stronger growth expectations.

Globally, like-sized IT services stocks are trading at a cheaper valuation than Happiest Minds. For instance, after Persistent Systems in June said it will acquire Nagarro, the latter’s trailing P/E multiple doubled to 20x in a short time, but Nagarro is still cheaper than Happiest Minds. Similarly, mid-tier IT services firm EPAM Systems trades at about 16x P/E.

Consensus estimates peg Happiest Minds’ FY27 revenue growth at about 14.1 per cent. That is respectable, but not exceptional enough for a ‘buy’ through a major ownership and integration transition. Expected

net-profit growth is stronger at 27.6 per cent, but that also assumes some recovery in profitability. Recent history has shown why IT sector consensus numbers should be taken with a pinch of salt.

The longer-term numbers show why this matter. Happiest Minds delivered a 24.5 per cent revenue CAGR over the last five years, but adjusted net profit grew at only 5.8 per cent CAGR. Its five-year average EBITDA margin of 20.7 per cent slipped to 17.7 per cent in FY26, while net margin fell from a five-year average of 13 per cent to 9.3 per cent. So, the correction since 2021 has not merely been a valuation de-rating. Profitability has also normalised.

MERGER MATH

The proposed transaction announced on August 31 has two

HOLD

Happiest Minds Technologies ₹354.35

WHY

- Uncertainty due to AI disruption remains
- Synergies need execution proof
- Growth outlook remains moderate

parts. First, 83-year-old promoter Ashok Soota and Ashok Soota Medical Research LLP will sell 22.106 per cent of Happiest Minds to ITC Infotech for ₹1,329.72 crore. The sale happens in two tranches, 11 per cent at ₹390 a share and 11.106 per cent at ₹400.

Second, Happiest Minds will be absorbed into ITC Infotech. Happiest Minds shareholders will receive 25 ITC Infotech shares for every 81 Happiest Minds shares held. The joint valuation places Happiest Minds at ₹405 a share and an equity value of ₹6,167 crore, against ₹11,920 crore for ITC Infotech. The implied FY26 EV/EBITDA multiples are 15.1 times and 13.6 times, respectively.

However, all this must not be seen as validation that Happiest Minds is worth ₹405 a share. ITC Infotech is for most parts paying for it with its own shares and not cash. The shares of both companies are likely being valued based on a similar methodology. This way it is a safer transaction for ITC Infotech rather

paying cash in full.

Post merger, ITC Ltd, the parent of ITC Infotech, will own about 73.4 per cent of the listed combined entity. The remaining Happiest Minds promoter group will own about 7.6 per cent and be reclassified as public shareholders, while the current Happiest Minds public shareholders will own about 19 per cent. The combined entity will have more scale. FY26 pro-forma revenue is about ₹7,033 crore, adjusted EBITDA margin about 18.1 per cent, with over 19,000 employees, more than 800 clients and operations across 30-plus countries.

WAIT FOR PROOF

The strategic logic for the merger is clearer. Happiest Minds brings AI, digital and product engineering, data, cloud and cybersecurity, while ITC Infotech has deeper capabilities in SAP, product lifecycle management, Industry 4.0 and enterprise transformation. Geographically, Happiest Minds derives 59 per cent of revenue from the Americas and just 8 per cent from Europe. The combined entity is expected to have a more balanced mix of 38 per cent Americas, 31 per cent Europe and 31 per cent elsewhere.

There is also a long transition ahead. Amid relentless AI disruption and uncertainty, neither managements nor analysts can estimate medium-term revenue growth and margins with confidence. Investors should, therefore, demand a higher margin of safety in valuations before buying IT stocks. For now, patience is the better trade.

Holding out for improvements

CONSUMER DURABLES. Margin performance should track revenue growth for Havells’ prospects to recover

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Havells has reported a pricing-driven revenue growth in the last one year. This while margin improvement remains muted owing to higher raw material costs and lack of operating leverage from lower volume growth.

While the industrial facing segments fare relatively well, the consumer facing segments have not. We earlier recommended investors accumulate the stock on dips in Feb-2025 based on scope for margin improvement, continued growth in RAC (room air conditioners) and cables & wires segment. Only the cables & wires growth played out as weak summer sales last year impacted consumer sales and high raw material prices have impacted overall margins. Since our last call in February last year, the stock is down 25 per cent. We now recommend investors to hold the stock for the following reasons: scope for better growth following weakness last year, waning impact of higher commodity prices that have been passed on, and moderated valuations. The stock is now trading much lower to historical levels at 40 times one year forward earnings compared to 52 times five-year average and hence appears to factors concerns stemming from weakness in the previous year. Earnings estimates from Bloomberg expect flat earnings growth in FY27 but stronger growth in FY28 as margin improvement plays out.

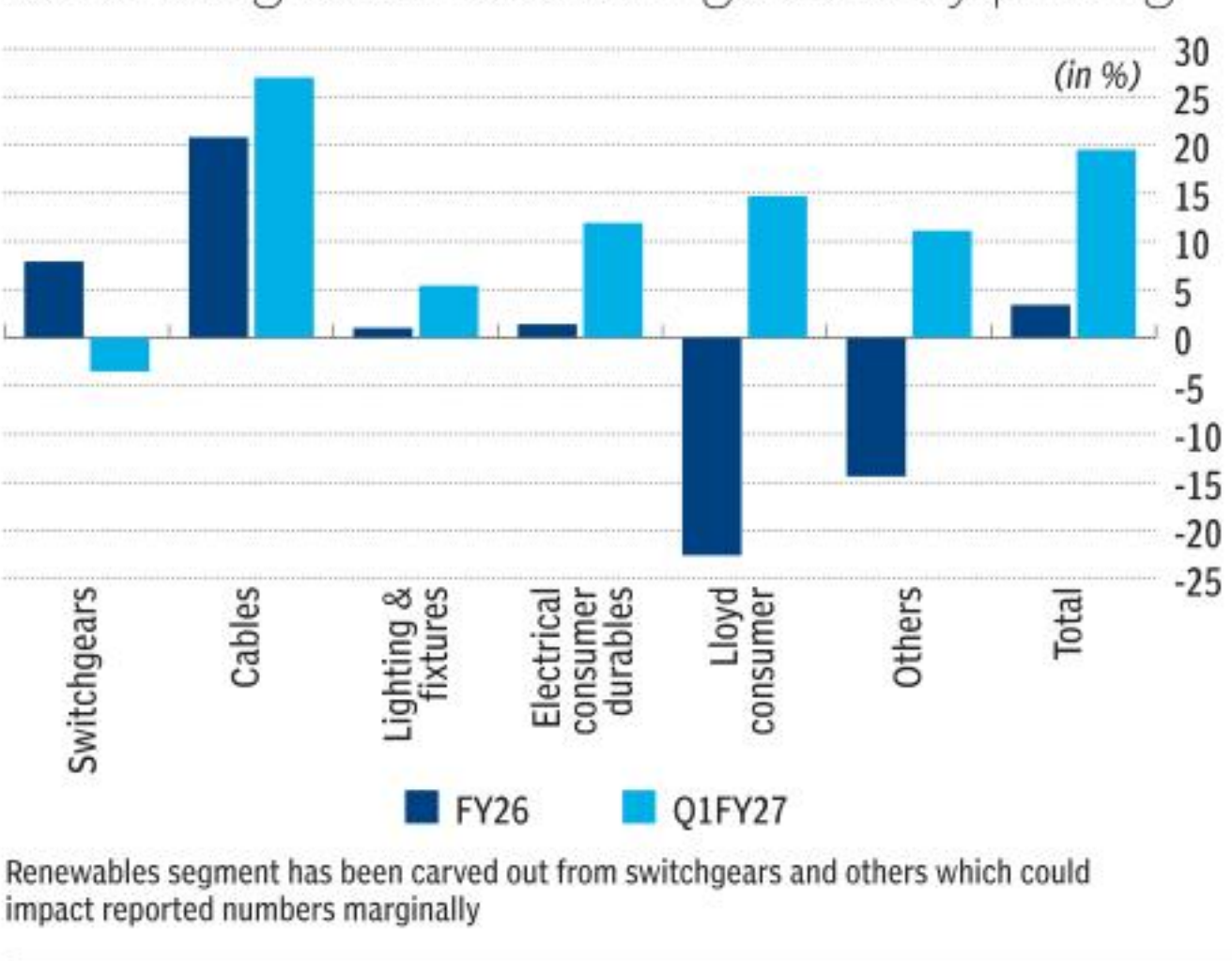
SEGMENT REVIEW

Industrial segments of Cables & Wires and Switchgears are better placed on growth and margins as shown in the figure.

Switchgear’s growth momentum was interrupted by middle east conflicts (15 per cent exports) and is expected to recover as alternate shipping routes and markets are established.

Cables and Wires, which is the leading segment, reported

Revenue growth recovering aided by pricing



27 per cent YoY growth in Q1FY27 but with flat volume growth. As copper had risen sharply, the company was able to pass on the cost, but volume growth has been impacted. As copper stabilises volumes are expected to recover in remainder of FY27. The segment faces strong demand from government infrastructure, solar, data centres and existing power and real estate demand. The company is also adding capacity with a ₹1,000 crore capex plan for FY27 (primarily cables and refrigeration segment and an R&D center).

Consumer division (lights, Electrical Consumer Durables and Lloyds in RAC and cooling products) is gradually recovering in Q1FY27 following a difficult FY26. GST rate cuts, lower interest rates and higher disposable income from lower taxes failed to aid the sector growth last year. Lloyds’ RAC division revenue declined 22 per cent in FY26 after 31-per cent CAGR in FY22-25 led by weak summer demand. With a low base, normalized channel inventory, and if aided by warmer weather, the RAC growth is likely to resume growth. The company is expanding refrigerator and RAC capacity as well.

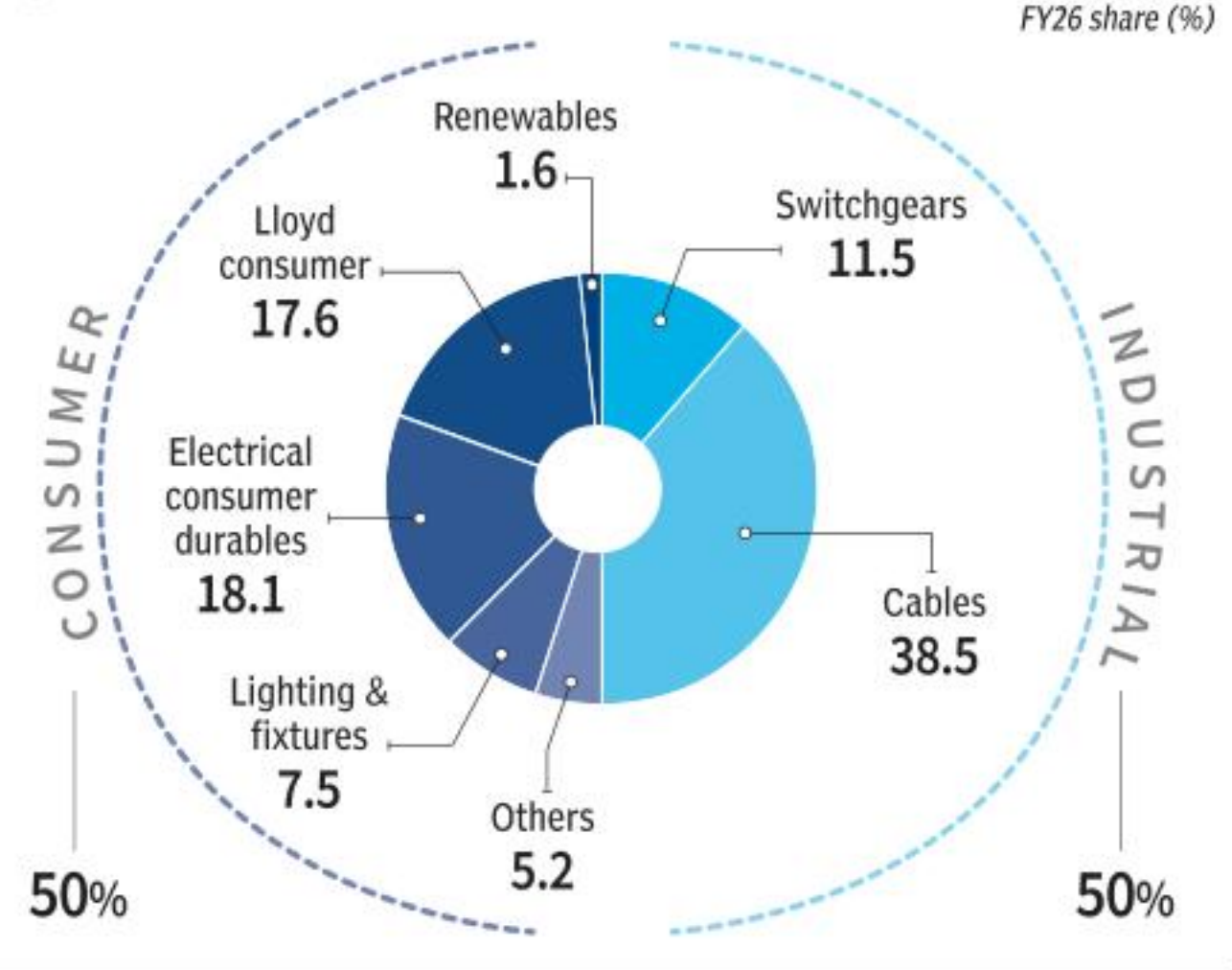
Havells has carved out renewable segments where it has launched solar inverters, solar

pumps, EVSE (Electric Vehicle Supply Equipment) and allied products. The fast-growing segment (21/236 per cent QoQ/ YoY growth in Q1FY27) contributed 4 per cent to overall Q1FY27 growth. Havells has bought a 9 per cent strategic stake in Goldi Solar (solar cells and module manufacturer) for ₹600 crore in Oct-2025 to secure a solar supply chain. Havells’ presence in white goods distribution, experience in manufacturing electric goods including EPC contracts and the secure supply chain - should ensure high growth from the segment.

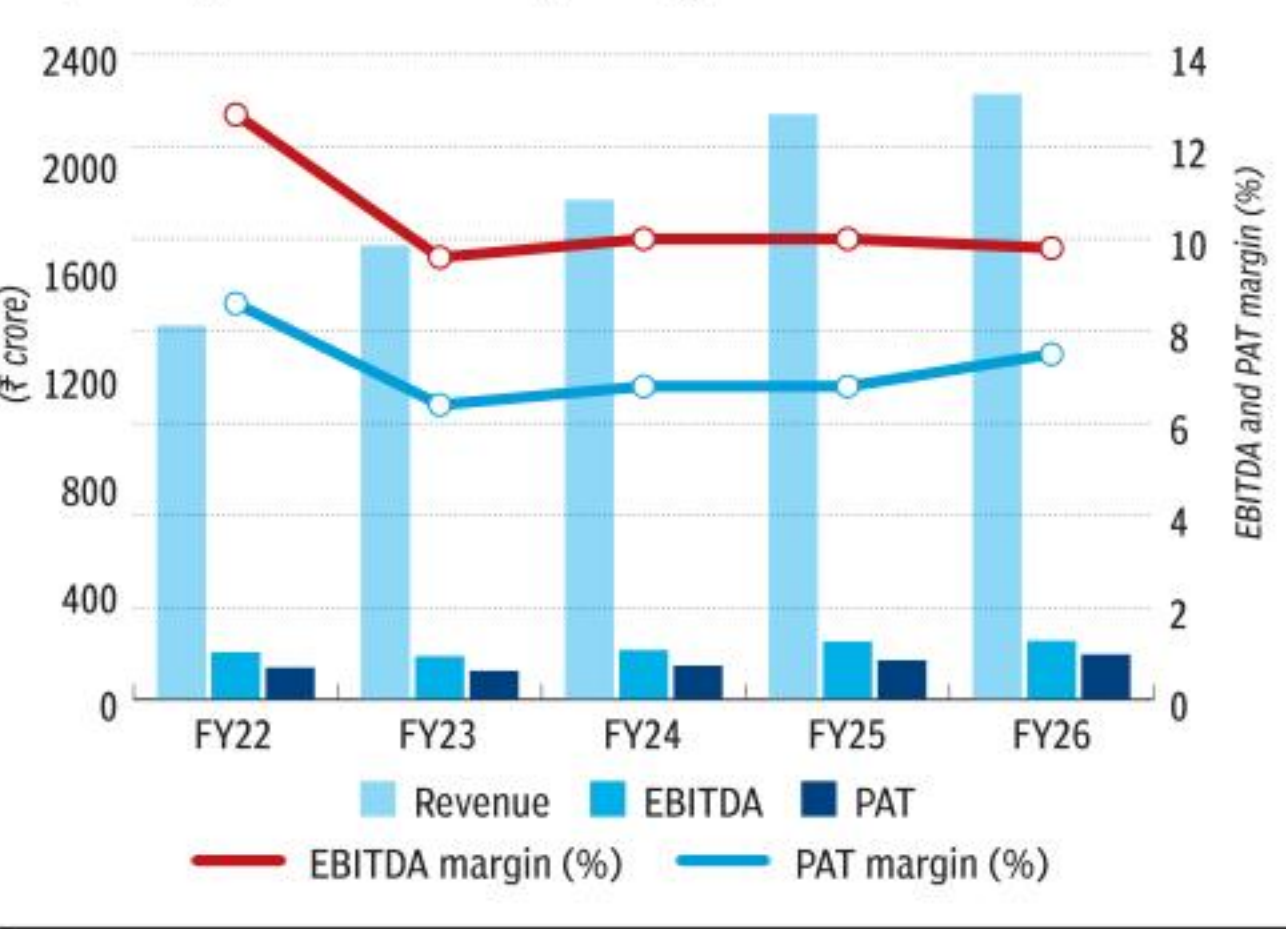
MARGIN PERFORMANCE

The company’s EBITDA margin declined from 12.7 per cent in FY22 to around 10 per cent in FY26 and to 7.2 per cent in Q1FY27. But the latest quarter’s

Split between industrial and consumer



Top line growth offset by margin decline



margin decline was owing to advertising expenses doubling to 4.4 per cent. This is an investment for consumer segment and will likely normalize in the year. The company has a strong balance sheet with a net cash position.

The overall margin weakness is again tied to consumer segments. Lighting segment is only recently stabilizing prices after an elongated period of price decline from Chinese competition (across industry). Intense competition impacted performance in fans, electric heaters and other products as well.

Havell’s Lloyds division which is led by RAC sales, posted 2.3 per cent EBIT margins in FY25 upending previous three

years of EBIT losses (average 4.7 per cent) as the division was scaling up. With sales declining by 22 per cent in FY26, the division EBIT margins again declined to -5.4 per cent in FY26. The segment expects to record profitability in FY27 driven by the recent price pass through. The price pass through includes both raw material inflation and the changes from BEE ratings starting Jan-2026 with stricter measures for energy ratings. The GST rate cuts have offset the price hikes and shielded the end user to an extent. The company is also revamping its distribution set-up to focus on being a sell-out brand (retailer to end user) than just a sell-in brand (manufacturer to retailer).

Taking Stock • bl • 5

businessline’s editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	Aug 28	Sep 4		
Reliance Industries	1,284.4	1,322.0	▲	2.9
Tata Steel	186.2	189.0	▲	1.5
Axis Bank	1,264.0	1,273.0	▲	0.7
NTPC	331.5	332.6	▲	0.3
Kotak Mahindra Bank	423.8	424.9	▲	0.3
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,705.1	1,709.0	▲	0.2
ICICI Bank	1,425.2	1,423.0	▼	-0.2
Power Grid	267.0	266.0	▼	-0.4
ITC	266.0	264.1	▼	-0.7
HDFC Bank	720.0	713.2	▼	-1.0
Sun Pharma	1,920.1	1,899.0	▼	-1.1
Infosys	1,143.7	1,130.0	▼	-1.2
Bharat Electronics	410.8	405.2	▼	-1.4
Bajaj Finserv	1,998.0	1,971.0	▼	-1.4
Eternal	327.8	323.0	▼	-1.4
Bajaj Finance	1,077.0	1,060.5	▼	-1.5
HCL Tech	1,316.5	1,294.0	▼	-1.7
HUL	2,010.4	1,974.0	▼	-1.8
TCS	2,344.0	2,300.9	▼	-1.8
L&T	4,041.0	3,966.0	▼	-1.9
Trent	2,899.0	2,845.0	▼	-1.9
UltraTech Cement	11,579.5	11,348.0	▼	-2.0
Bharti Airtel	1,882.0	1,842.0	▼	-2.1
Tata Motors PV	319.0	312.0	▼	-2.2
Tech Mahindra	1,636.0	1,592.0	▼	-2.7
SBI	1,046.1	1,017.0	▼	-2.8
Asian Paints	2,602.0	2,527.8	▼	-2.9
Titan	5,165.0	5,010.0	▼	-3.0
M & M	3,332.4	3,168.9	▼	-4.9
Maruti Suzuki	13,385.5	12,700.0	▼	-5.1

How sectoral indices moved

	Aug 28	Sep 4	Movement	% change
OIL&GAS	25,977.7	26,169.7	▲	0.7
REALTY	7,077.9	7,093.0	▲	0.2
BANKEX	64,963.5	64,904.4	▼	-0.1
POWER	7,512.8	7,475.8	▼	-0.5
PSU	20,651.4	20,544.4	▼	-0.5
HEALTHCARE	51,595.0	50,913.2	▼	-1.3
METALS	42,969.4	42,293.7	▼	-1.6
FMCG	17,761.6	17,470.0	▼	-1.6
TECK	15,606.7	15,318.8	▼	-1.8
IT	29,978.9	29,401.1	▼	-1.9
CAPITAL GOODS	79,515.0	77,868.6	▼	-2.1
CONSUMER DURABLES	65,066.7	63,244.0	▼	-2.8

WHO AM I?

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- Both my founders are chartered accountants. The next generation of both founders is actively involved in my growth, and neither is a chartered accountant.
- My founder family continues to own almost a two-thirds stake, while the number of shareholders has been on the decline post IPO.
- My recent acquisition, valued at more than my full-year profits, led to the resignation of an independent director citing governance challenges.
- I was valued at a single-digit P/E multiple, with a market cap of less than 15 per cent of annual revenue, until recently.
- I have delivered more than three times the return to shareholders since listing a few years ago.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

UNIFI CAPITAL
Investing With Conviction

Last week’s stock:
Gokaldas Exports
Last week’s winner:
Shruti Shinde

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,898) fell 1.1 per cent over the last week, extending the decline for fourth consecutive week. Whereas Nifty Bank (57,370) was down by a marginal 0.2 per cent during the same period, outperforming the benchmark index.

The futures and options data of Nifty 50 shows a clear bearish inclination whereas that of Nifty Bank lacks conviction on both sides. Below is an analysis.

NIFTY 50
Nifty (Sept) futures (24,048) breached the important support at 24,250 early last week. After marking an intra-week low of 23,940 on Wednesday, it recovered a little and closed the week higher at 24,048 on Friday.

As the contract declined, the outstanding open interest increased 9 per cent to 168.1 lakh contracts. A price drop along with increase in open interest show fresh short build-up.

That said, the PCR (Put Call Ratio) of September options stood at 1.1 on Friday. Although the ratio is greater than 1, it dropped from 1.2 to 1.1 over the last week as traders sold comparatively more number of calls, a bearish sign.

The chart of Nifty futures also show weakness. At the moment, there are no signs of a bullish reversal. The prevailing price action shows strong downward momentum and so, we expect further decline from the current level.

In the near-term, the September futures is likely to drop to 23,800 and subsequently to 23,630, which are the notable support levels.

However, if there is a recovery



F&O TRACKER: Nifty stays weak while Nifty Bank remains range-bound

from the current level of 24,048, only a clear breakout of 24,250 can turn the outlook positive again. In this case, Nifty futures can rally to 24,550 and 24,750.

Overall, the probability for a fall is high and so, traders can consider fresh short positions.

Strategy: Go short on Nifty futures (Sept) if it inches up to 24,180. Place stop-loss at 24,300.

Book profits at 23,800.

Option traders can consider buying 23800-put (₹140.20) of September monthly expiry. Buy when the premium dips to ₹110 and place stop-loss at ₹40. Book profits at ₹260.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank (Sept) futures (57,775) opened the last week on

- BEARISH CUES**
- Nifty futures breaches 24,250
 - Consider shorting Nifty futures
 - Nifty Bank futures continues consolidation

a flat note. However, on Wednesday, it opened with a considerable gap-down and slipped to a low of 57,211.

But the contract immediately recovered and closed the week at 57,775.

Thus, the price band of 57,500-58,500, which has been the trading range for the September futures since early August, remains valid.

As Nifty Bank futures ended the week flat, there was not much change in the outstanding open interest. It stood at 20.2 lakh contracts on Friday compared to 20.1 lakh contracts a week ago.

Also, the PCR of September options was at 1 on Friday, showing that the traders have sold almost equal number of call and put options.

Hence, the derivatives data of Nifty Bank does not indicate a definite sentiment.

In line with this, the chart also shows that the sideways band stays true and only a decisive breach of either 57,500 or 58,500 will lend us clues about the direction of the next leg of trend.

A breakout of 58,500 can trigger a rally to 59,300 and subsequently to 60,000. However, if the contract breaches the support at 57,500, it can decline to 57,000. Potential support below 57,000 is at 56,500.

Strategy: Given the uncertainty with respect to trend, we suggest traders stay out.

Execution costs of bull call spread

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Strategy more involved when long option is ITM as we approach expiry

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

A bull call spread involves going long on a lower strike call and short on a higher strike call, with both calls on the same underlying with same expiry date.

This week, we discuss the costs associated in executing a bull call spread.

EXECUTION COSTS

Typically, a bull call spread is initiated in two legs — long leg and short leg separately. The issue is that short options, being obligations, attract SPAN margins. Note that short call is an obligation to sell. NSE allows SPAN spread margin benefit if your short call is covered by a long call. Therefore, it is beneficial to place the order for long call first. After the order for the long call is confirmed, you should immediately place an order for the short call to avail the SPAN spread margin.

This, however, exposes you to the risk of slippages, albeit marginally. Suppose the short call is trading at 90 when you place the long call order. By the time you place the order for the short call, its price could have dropped to,



TAKE NOTE

NSE allows SPAN spread margin benefit if your short call is covered by a long call

say, 87. Fortunately, new-generation, technology-driven brokers allow you to place a basket order. That is, you can choose the long and the short strikes, and implement the call spread as one order. The order is sequenced to help you avail the SPAN spread margin benefits. Also, such basket orders lower slippage costs.

What about closing the position? If you are manually placing the orders for each leg, you must close the short leg first and then the long leg. This helps you avoid triggering the higher SPAN margin on your short position. This is how basket orders for bull call spreads must be created. Note that when you choose your short call position, SPAN margin is released immediately. What if you close the long call first? The sale proceeds are immediately available in your trading account, which you can use to buy the strike to close your short leg. But you will briefly trigger the SPAN margin requirements, as the

short call will, momentarily, be a naked position. The short position will be closed but will attract a penalty if your trading account does not have enough money to fund the margin.

OPTIONAL READING

Bull call spread gets more involved when your long position is in-the-money (ITM) as the options approach expiry. This is because your long leg will attract delivery margins, as delivery is compulsory for ITM calls at expiry. Your broker will presume that your ITM long calls will be exercised at expiry and charge delivery margins, starting four days from the expiry date. So, the long leg will attract delivery margins whereas the short leg will attract SPAN margins.

That means, the capital allocated for your bull call spread will be high. You can reduce the margin requirements by closing your spread position before the Wednesday preceding the Tuesday expiry. The trade-off is that your potential gains may be lower.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Rebound expected

BULLION CUES. Participants can consider longs

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Precious metals slipped last week. Gold (\$4,429.80/ounce) and silver (\$66.20/ounce) were down 0.6 and 0.2 per cent respectively. In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,52,767/10 gm) lost 2.2 per cent and silver futures (₹2,37,658/kg) was down 2 per cent.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,52,767)

Gold futures (Oct) declined last week to mark a low of ₹1,49,665 on Wednesday. But since ₹1,50,000 is a support, where the 50-day moving average and the 61.8 per cent Fibonacci retracement of the recent rally coincides, there was a rebound.

As long as the base at ₹1,50,000 remains valid, the outlook will be positive. So, we expect the rally to resume. In the near-term, gold futures can surpass the prior high of ₹1,64,773 and touch ₹1,67,000.

Instead, if the contract breaches the support at ₹1,50,000, the downswing can extend to ₹1,44,000.

Trade strategy: Buy gold futures (Oct) at ₹1,52,700. Place stop-loss at ₹1,49,000. When the



contract goes up to ₹1,60,000, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,55,000. Book profits at ₹1,67,000.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,37,658)

Silver futures (Dec) fell and made a low of ₹2,31,811 last Wednesday. But it immediately recovered since there was a support at ₹2,32,000.

We anticipate a rally in silver futures. Although ₹2,37,500 and ₹2,55,000 are resistance, the contract can surpass these levels and rise to ₹2,60,000.

Instead, if the base at ₹2,32,000 is breached, silver futures can fall to ₹2,25,000.

Trade strategy: Buy silver futures (Dec) at ₹2,37,500 and place stop-loss at ₹2,29,000. On a rally to ₹2,50,000, tighten the stop-loss to ₹2,42,000. Book profits at ₹2,60,000.

Prices could ease

CRUDE CHECK. Consider buying the dips

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Oil prices rallied through the last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$96.30/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,578/barrel) rose 9.3 per cent and 7.4 per cent respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$96.30)

Brent crude futures saw an uptick in price in the first half of last week. During the latter half, it stayed flat, retaining the gains.

However, there is a barrier ahead at \$98, where a rising trendline coincides. This can trigger a price correction, possibly to \$90.50, its 21-day moving average. Subsequent support is at \$88.75. A breach of this can turn the outlook bearish. Support below \$88.75 is at \$84.

On the other hand, if Brent crude futures breaks out of \$98, it can extend the rally to \$101.50. A rally past this level can lift the contract to \$110.

MCX CRUDE OIL (₹8,578)

Crude oil futures (Sept) rallied last week and hit a high of ₹8,791 on Thursday. But it ended the



week lower at ₹8,578. A weekly close above ₹8,500 is a positive sign and the price action shows that there is a buying interest between ₹8,400 and ₹8,600.

Therefore, further upside is highly likely. That said, before the next upswing, the contract might moderate, possibly to ₹8,085 where the 21-day moving average lies.

A rally, either from the current level of ₹8,578 or after a dip to ₹8,085, can lift crude oil futures to ₹9,000. A breakout of ₹9,000 can take the contract to ₹10,000.

On the other hand, if the support at ₹8,000 is breached, the crude oil futures can fall to ₹7,500.

Trade strategy: Buy crude oil futures if the price dips to ₹8,100. Target and stop-loss can be ₹9,000 and ₹7,800, respectively.

F & O QUERY



AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

What is the outlook of Crompton? I have got a position on September expiry 240 CE bought for an average price ₹7.10. Can the price rise above ₹250 in September?

Debesh Goswami



Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals (₹232.40): The stock has been in a downtrend since mid-May. It started to decline on the back of the resistance at ₹300. On Friday, it rebounded on the back of the support at ₹225. The uptick can

extend to ₹240, a resistance where the 21-day moving average coincides. If the scrip surpasses ₹240, it can extend the rally to ₹250. However, if the stock falls off ₹240, it can retest ₹225. A breach of this level can drag the price down to ₹200. This is a crucial support and this base is unlikely to be invalidated, at least in September. Overall, as it stands, there is a chance for the stock to rise to ₹240-250. But whether it will happen right away or after a decline to ₹200 is uncertain. Also, whether the breakout of ₹250 will occur before the end of September expiry is unclear.

Given the prevailing conditions, we suggest exiting the 240-call option at the ongoing premium when the underlying stock price hits ₹238-240 price band.

Do you recommend long or short position in Keynes Technology futures now?

Palani Shanmugam



Keynes Technology India (₹3,598): As of today September 4, this stock in under futures and options trading ban. Nevertheless, here is our analysis on the stock, which you may refer to in initiating trades when the scrip comes out of the ban.

Last week, the price dropped by 9 per cent. But after it found support at ₹3,450, the stock saw a rebound.

A potential rally from the current level can lift the stock back to ₹4,000 in the near-term. However, if the bears gather enough strength to drag the price below ₹3,500, the sell-off can intensify. Notable support below ₹3,500 can be spotted at ₹3,175 and ₹3,050.

Broadly, you can stay on the long side of the trade until the support at ₹3,500 holds. You may consider shorts in case the base at ₹3,500 is decisively breached.

Send your queries to derivatives@thehindu.co.in.

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Sep 4	Weekly change %	As on Sep 4	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	33689	39	261701	9
Future Index Short	269527	19	51859	-18
Net Futures	-235838	16	209842	19
Index Call options Long	561316	5	3669328	11
Index Call options Short	864770	13	3443458	7
Net Call options	-303454	32	225870	148
Index Put options Long	1070255	5	2808996	15
Index Put options Short	489344	15	3525254	11
Net Put Options	580911	-2	-716258	-1

FII's have increased net short on index futures. They have also added net short on index call options. These point to bearish expectations.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Sep 4)				
KEI	4,850.00	-12.9	72.8	140.3
POLYCAB	8,300.00	-8.7	81.7	96.6
MAHABANK	85.95	2.6	584.9	94.3
ATHERENERG	1,584.00	-2.0	112.3	91.7
MARUTI	12,694.00	-5.1	79.1	73.5
FALL (as on Sep 4)				
LICHSGFIN	562.05	5.1	519.2	-11.7
GRASIM	3,322.00	1.0	113.5	-5.1
NHPC	76.25	1.9	1989.6	-3.9
MFSL	1,548.40	-1.0	98.1	-3.6
POLICYBZR	1,836.00	1.4	91.3	-2.8

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Sep 7)

INOXWIND	KAYNES	LICHSGFIN	SAIL
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Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2025)	Price (₹)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on Sep 4)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Sep	347.6 (0.6)	4,304 (-3)	Short covering
COPPER	30-Sep	1,378.6 (-0.9)	10,772 (-7)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOIL	21-Sep	8,578.0 (7.4)	15,378 (47)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	21-Sep	8,576.0 (7.4)	46,614 (61)	Long build-up
GOLD	5-Oct	1,52,767.0 (-2.2)	10,768 (-2)	Long unwinding
GOLDGUINEA	30-Sep	1,22,913.0 (-2.3)	11,171 (4)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-Oct	1,52,910.0 (-2.3)	31,642 (38)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Sep	15,357.0 (-2.3)	2,16,160 (7)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	30-Sep	1,53,081.0 (-2.2)	24,664 (-2)	Long unwinding
LEAD	30-Sep	196.4 (-0.7)	768 (31)	Short build-up
NATURALGAS	25-Sep	280.5 (1.6)	33,406 (-18)	Short covering
SILVER	4-Dec	2,37,658.0 (-2.0)	12,293 (48)	Short build-up
SILVERM	30-Nov	2,39,457.0 (-2.0)	32,230 (14)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Nov	2,39,542.0 (-2.0)	1,01,237 (10)	Short build-up
ZINC	30-Sep	418.3 (1.0)	2,777 (8)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Sep 4)				
USDINR	28-Sep	94.52 (-1.1)	27,04,337 (138)	Short build-up
EURINR	28-Sep	110.26 (-1.2)	4,531 (-12)	Long unwinding
GBPINR	28-Sep	128.24 (-1.5)	26,597 (76)	Short build-up
JPYINR	28-Sep	60.51 (0.5)	378 (3050)	Long build-up

F&O Strategy

Long Strangle on SBI Cards

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook for the stock of SBI Cards and Payments Services (₹658.25) remains bearish. Supports are at 632 and at ₹585. Resistance is at ₹695. Broadly, we expect the stock to remain volatile in the short term.

F&O pointers: SBI Cards September futures closed at ₹661.45 against the spot price of ₹658.25. The counter shed open positions from 2.24 crore shares to 2.15 crore shares in the last 10 days as the stock moved in the ₹640-660 range. Option trading indicates that the stock could move in the ₹650-700 range.

Strategy: Consider a long strangle on SBI Cards. This



can be initiated by simultaneously buying 670-call and 650-put. As these options closed with a premium of ₹13.80 and ₹12.40 respectively, this strategy would cost investors ₹20,960 (market lot 800 shares). This would be the maximum loss, and that will occur if the stock is stuck between ₹670 and ₹650 through the expiry.

But profit potentials are high if the stock moves sharply in either direction. The trade will yield positive results if stock moves past ₹696.20 or below ₹623.80. We advise traders to exit the position at a profit or loss of ₹2,000-2,500. Holding the position for a couple of weeks may give desired results.

Follow-up: We had advised traders to long on Hindalco. It would have triggered stop loss.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Short Take

Due Date Rate explained

bl. research bureau

Due Date Rate (DDR) is the rate of a contract calculated on the final trading day (contract expiry day) for the purpose of settlement. It is also called as Final Settlement Price (FSP). All positions that are kept open until the expiry will be settled at this rate. Each commodity category has different ways of calculating the DDR.



In case of gold, copper etc the DDR is the average of the polled spot prices of the last three trading days. This includes the expiry day also. Assume that the expiry day is E, then the polled spot price on E, E1 and E2 will be taken for the calculation of DDR. In case if spot price is not available for any of these days, then the polled spot price on E4 will be considered. Spot prices are polled twice a day from the physical market participants for all commodities. The spot price fixed based on the second poll for the day on the last three days is taken into consideration for DDR calculation.

For products such as crude oil and natural gas, the DDR calculation is different. For these two contracts, the settlement price of the front month contracts of crude oil and natural gas traded on the NYMEX converted to Indian rupees will be considered as the DDR. Suppose on 21 Sep 2026, the expiry date for MCX Crude Oil, the NYMEX Crude has settled at \$100 on that day. Assume that RBI's reference rate for USDINR on that day is 95. So, the DDR for MCX Crude will be ₹9,500 (100*95).

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank indices are showing diverging signals after the last week's fall. Nifty and Sensex were down about a per cent. The fall last week has taken the Nifty well below the key support level of 24,000. This has negated our view of seeing a rise to 24,500-24,700 that we have been expecting. Nifty looks vulnerable to fall more from here.

Sensex on the other hand is poised just above a crucial support. The price action this week is going to be crucial. Barring the fall on Wednesday, Nifty Bank index broadly remained inside the 57,000-58,000 range. We will have to wait for a breakout on either side of this range to get clarity on the next move.

FPIS SELL

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) snapped their six-week buying streak last week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$917 million. With this, the month of September had begun on a negative note. Need to watch closely the FPI action. If they intensify their selling, then Sensex and Nifty can remain under pressure.

NIFTY 50 (23,897.70)

Short-term view: The fall and close below 24,000 has turned the short-term picture negative. Strong resistance will now be in the 24,000-24,200 region. Nifty can fall to 23,600 from here. The price action thereafter is going to be crucial.

A bounce from around 23,600 can trigger a relief rise to 24,000. But a break below 23,600 will increase the selling pressure and drag the index down to 23,400-23,300. A sustained rise above 24,200 is needed to bring back the chances of seeing 24,500-24,700 on the upside.

Medium-term view: The fall last week has reduced the chances of the rise within the 22,000-26,500 range that we have been expecting. A break below 23,600 will completely negate that for now. If that happens, then there is a danger of seeing 23,000-22,500 on the downside in the coming weeks.

However, there is no change in our long-term bullish view. We expect the Nifty to breach 26,500 eventually and rise to

Diverging cues

INDEX OUTLOOK.

Nifty 50 looks weak. Sensex has a support while Nifty Bank is still range-bound

Nifty 50: Breaks the key support



28,000 and 30,000 in the long term. The fall last week is just delaying the expected bullish breakout above 26,500.

Our long-term bullish view will go wrong only if the Nifty breaks below 22,000.

NIFTY BANK (57,369.65)

Short-term view: Barring the fall to 56,823 on Wednesday, the Nifty Bank index remained well within the 57,000-58,250 range. The immediate outlook is unclear. The index can continue to oscillate between this range. A breakout on either side of 57,000-58,250 will then determine the next leg of move. A break below 57,000 can drag the index down to 56,500 and 56,000. On the other hand, a break above 58,250 will be bullish to see 59,000 and 60,000 on the upside.

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Bajaj Finserv (₹1,971)

Strong base ahead



After hitting a high of ₹2,119.30 on August 5, the stock of Bajaj Finserv has seen a price correction. Currently trading at ₹1,971, it has notable support levels at ₹1,940 and ₹1,900. Within these two levels lies the 50-day moving average support. Hence, the price band of ₹1,900-1,940 is a strong base.

There is a good chance for the stock to rebound on the back of these levels. A rally, either from the current level of ₹1,971 or after a fall to ₹1,900-1,940 price band, can take the stock to ₹2,300. Traders can buy now at ₹1,971 and ₹1,920. Place stop-loss at ₹1,875. On a rally to ₹2,100 and ₹2,200, alter the stop-loss to ₹2,000 and ₹2,150, respectively. Book profits at ₹2,300.

IGL (₹158.05)

Sees fresh breakout



The stock of Indraprastha Gas Ltd (IGL) has been consolidating since early July. It has been oscillating between ₹147 and ₹156. But last week, the scrip closed above the resistance of ₹156 as it appreciated a little over 7 per cent. Consequently, the price has now risen above both 21- and 50-day moving averages. While there is a chance for the stock to see some price moderation, possibly to ₹154, we expect the stock to eventually resume the uptrend and appreciate to ₹172 in the near-term. So, traders can go long now at ₹158 and accumulate at ₹154. Place stop-loss at ₹145. When the stock rises to ₹165, raise the stop-loss to ₹158. Book profits at ₹172.

Titagarh Rail Systems (₹871.90)

Bulls gaining traction



The stock of Titagarh Rail Systems has been charting a sideways trend, between ₹800 and ₹880, for the last couple of months. While this range is yet to be breached, there are signs on the chart of the bulls gaining traction. Towards the end of the last week, there was a notable uptick in price and the scrip is now above key moving averages. This happened on the back of the support at ₹800. As long as this level holds true, the likelihood of a breakout of ₹880 will remain high. Once this occurs, the stock can see a quick rally to ₹1,100. Buy at ₹871 and ₹840. Place stop-loss at ₹780. On a rally to ₹950 and ₹1,050, revise the stop-loss to ₹890 and ₹1,000, respectively. Exit at ₹1,100.

Support holds well

US MARKET OUTLOOK.

The US benchmark indices can rise more

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and NASDAQ Composite index have recovered very well after falling in the first half last week. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index recouped all their losses and were up 0.09 per cent and 0.4 per cent, respectively for the week. The Dow Jones on the other hand ended the week marginally lower by 0.27 per cent.

On the charts, the picture broadly remains positive. The US benchmark indices have potential to rise further going forward. Here is our analysis.

DOW JONES (53,419.33)

The index is getting good support around 52,700. Near-term resistance is around 53,900. A break above it can take the Dow Jones higher to 54,750-55,000 in the coming weeks. An extended rise to 56,000 is also possible over the medium term.

The short-term outlook will turn negative if the index declines below 52,700. If that happens, a fall to 52,200-52,000 can be seen. Such a fall can increase the downside pressure.

S&P 500 (7,718.61)

The support at 7,600 has held very well in line with our expectation. The S&P 500 index fell to a low of 7,611.20 and then risen back sharply. That keeps the door open to see 7,770-7,800 on

MIXED PICTURE

The US dollar index is stuck between 98.50 and 99.85 and keeps the near-term outlook unclear

the upside in the short term. The S&P 500 index has to fall below 7,600 to turn the short-term picture negative and see 7,500 and lower levels.

From a big picture, a decisive break above 7,800 can boost the momentum. It can then take the index up to 8,000 in the medium term. We reiterate that the region around 8,000 is a strong resistance which can halt the rally and trigger a reversal.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,506.99)

The 26,000-25,900 support zone has limited the downside for the third consecutive week. The NASDAQ Composite index has risen back well after touching a low of 25,995 last week.

That keeps the bias positive to see 27,000-27,200 in the short term. A break above 27,200 can trigger an extended rise to 28,000-28,200.

We repeat that the 28,000-28,200 is a crucial long-term resistance zone where the upmove can halt. A reversal thereafter can drag the index down to 27,000-26,000 and even lower. So, it is important to turn cautious as the index approaches

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (23,168.35)

Contrary to our expectation, the Nifty Midcap 150 index broke the support at 23,300 and fell to a low of 22,935 last week. Important resistance is in the 23,350-23,400 region. A strong rise above 23,400 is needed to turn the short-term picture positive. Only then the rise to 23,750 mentioned last week can happen.

Failure to get a strong follow-through rise from here and a subsequent fall below 23,100 will keep the short-term picture negative. In that case, a fall to 22,800-22,750 or even 22,700 can be seen.

However, the broader bullish view is still intact. A fall beyond 22,700 is less likely. So, we continue to retain our bullish view of seeing 26,000-26,500 in the medium-term and 28,000 in the long term. A rise above 23,750 will clear the way for this rally.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (18,481.40)

The index has risen back very well from the low of 18,153.60 last week recovering almost all the loss. That indicates the presence of strong buyers at lower levels. If this bounce sustains, 18,600 can be seen in the near term. A break above it can take the index further higher to 18,800. The overall bullish view remains intact. We expect the Nifty Smallcap 250 index to target 22,500-23,000 in the medium term and 24,000-24,500 in the long term.

The level of 18,000 is an important support for now. The short-term outlook will turn negative only if the index breaks below this support. That in turn can drag the index down to 17,500 or even lower. However, such a fall will not disrupt the long-term bullish picture. It will only delay the expected rally.

bl.portfolio video

Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English

Tamil

TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl. research bureau

I have shares of HDFC Bank bought at ₹635. What is the outlook for this stock?

Rohit Mehendarkar



HDFC Bank (₹713): The outlook is negative. The stock has declined below a crucial support level of ₹740. A fall to ₹680-₹670 is possible in the short-term. A bounce from there can trigger a corrective rise to ₹710-₹720. But from

a big picture, HDFC Bank looks vulnerable to break ₹670 and fall to ₹620, a strong support. It can halt the fall. A strong bounce from around ₹620 and a subsequent rise above ₹750 will be bullish from a long-term perspective. For now, it is better to book profit and exit the stock. You can consider re-entering the stock around ₹630 again. In case the stock goes up above ₹750 straightaway from around ₹670, then you have to be ready to get into the stock at higher levels.

I have bought S.P. Apparels at ₹1,025. What is the outlook? Can I hold this stock for a year?

Ishwar Lal Pareek



S.P. Apparels (₹1,072): The short-term outlook is positive. The stock can rise to ₹1,200 or even ₹1,350 in the coming months. However, a rise beyond ₹1,350 might not be very easy as that is a strong resistance. There

are good chances for the price to turn lower towards ₹1,000 from this resistance. Keep a stop-loss at ₹910 and hold the stock. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,060 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹1,170. Exit 30 per cent of your holding at ₹1,210 and move the stop-loss higher to ₹1,140 for the rest of your holdings. When the price goes up to ₹1,260 and ₹1,310 move the stop-loss higher to ₹1,190 and ₹1,280, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,330.

I have shares of Websol Energy Systems. My purchase price is ₹116. Can I accumulate more and hold the stock for some more time?

VPS Krishna



Websol Energy Systems (₹75): The stock is in a strong downtrend since January 2025. Some support is at ₹72. But the chances are high for the stock to break this support. Such a break will see Websol Energy

Systems share price tumbling to ₹40-₹35. Resistance is in the ₹100-₹115 region. In case a bounce from ₹72 is seen, then the share price must rise past ₹115 to turn positive. But that looks unlikely. So, it will become very risky if you intend to hold the stock for some more time. It is better to exit the stock and accept the loss now. Always make sure to have a stop-loss in place whenever you enter a trade to help minimise the loss.

I have Tarsons Products shares. My average purchase price is ₹375. What is the technical outlook?

Nooveeksha Reddy, Hyderabad



Tarsons Products (₹334): The broader trend is down. The rise from the low of ₹164 made in March looks like a correction. Crucial resistance is in the ₹350-₹360 region which is holding for now. A strong break

above ₹360 and a subsequent rise above ₹400 will indicate a bullish trend reversal. If you have the risk appetite, then keep a stop-loss at ₹305 and hold the stock. If the price falls from here, then adhere to the stop-loss and exit. On the other hand, if the price goes up, then move the stop-loss up to ₹380 when the price goes up to ₹420. Move the stop-loss further up to ₹430 and ₹510 when the price goes up to ₹490 and ₹540, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹560.

* Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

- Tejas Networks
- Sammaan Capital
- Urban Company
- Wockhardt
- Emcure Pharmaceuticals

Last week's prize winner
R Srikanthan

Last week's winning stock
Bank of Maharashtra

Closing price (Aug 28)
₹84.22

Closing price (Sep 04)
₹85.75

Return
1.82 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	107.6	80960	1.1	0.7	-2.0	11.2	11.1	12.8	0.38
*****	Invesco India Largecap	72.6	1931	1.8	0.7	4.9	13.4	10.5	12.1	0.32
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	89.2	54225	1.2	0.6	-1.9	10.9	12.8	13.2	0.44
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	222.2	2632	1.7	0.7	2.3	11.4	9.8	11.9	0.32
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	61.5	17136	1.4	0.5	-1.7	10.0	8.1	12.4	0.25
*****	JM Large Cap	153.9	402	2.1	0.8	1.4	10.3	9.8	10.5	0.30
*****	SBI Large Cap	92.6	55431	1.2	0.7	0.8	9.2	8.9	11.1	0.29
****	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	517.9	29944	1.4	0.8	-0.8	9.8	8.9	10.9	0.28
****	Bandhan Large Cap	78.8	2145	1.7	0.8	2.9	12.6	9.7	11.9	0.30
****	DSP Large Cap	453.0	7228	1.5	0.8	-2.8	10.5	8.4	9.9	0.27
****	Edelweiss Large Cap	83.5	1443	1.8	0.6	0.9	9.6	8.8	11.7	0.27
****	Franklin Ind Large Cap	1018.3	7488	1.5	0.9	-0.4	9.9	7.8	10.0	0.24
****	HDFC Large Cap	1128.5	40198	1.3	0.8	0.1	9.7	11.0	11.8	0.36
****	HSBC Large Cap	475.8	1839	1.8	1.0	1.2	9.9	8.1	11.1	0.25
****	Kotak Large Cap	564.2	11028	1.5	0.6	-0.4	9.9	8.5	11.5	0.27
****	Mahi Manu Large Cap	22.0	711	2.0	0.7	-3.7	7.9	7.4	-	0.22
****	Tata Large Cap	506.2	2784	1.7	0.8	2.4	10.2	9.1	11.0	0.29
****	Groww Largecap	42.7	136	2.1	0.9	0.1	10.0	8.3	10.1	0.24
****	Mirae Asset Large Cap	111.5	3829	1.3	0.5	-0.8	8.4	7.3	11.7	0.23
****	Union Largecap	23.1	4378	2.1	1.3	-0.9	7.8	7.0	-	0.21
****	UTI Large Cap	265.4	12189	1.5	0.8	-2.7	7.5	6.4	10.6	0.19
****	Axis Large Cap	60.0	31632	1.3	0.7	-0.7	9.1	5.1	11.2	0.13
****	LIC MF Large Cap	53.4	1387	1.8	0.9	-3.7	7.5	5.5	9.4	0.15
****	PGIM India Large Cap	330.2	547	2.1	0.8	-2.9	6.6	5.6	9.1	0.15
****	- Taurus Large Cap	168.9	56	2.1	1.9	8.9	13.5	10.5	9.9	0.30

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	141.7	19777	1.4	0.4	6.4	17.5	15.8	14.8	0.50
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1045.0	32706	1.3	0.7	4.7	15.6	16.1	14.6	0.58
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	124.2	3496	1.7	0.6	12.6	13.9	14.4	15.0	0.43
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	35.1	16802	1.4	0.6	7.6	14.8	11.5	-	0.33
*****	HDFC Large & Mid Cap	348.8	30099	1.4	0.8	4.0	12.8	14.3	14.2	0.46
*****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	110.7	11746	1.5	0.6	9.4	22.1	16.3	15.8	0.46
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	185.4	6514	1.6	0.8	5.3	14.9	13.7	13.4	0.45
*****	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	93.7	514	2.1	0.9	8.9	13.2	11.3	12.2	0.33
****	DSP Large & Mid Cap	617.5	18231	1.4	0.5	2.2	13.1	11.3	13.4	0.36
****	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	91.1	4789	1.6	0.5	6.5	13.6	12.2	13.9	0.38
****	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	30.2	5479	1.6	0.7	12.3	17.4	13.8	-	0.36
****	Kotak Large & Mid Cap	352.1	32050	1.3	0.5	4.4	13.0	12.5	14.2	0.39
****	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	157.7	45275	1.3	0.5	5.9	11.9	10.2	15.5	0.31
****	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1497.0	7705	1.5	0.9	2.6	14.6	12.9	12.4	0.42
****	SBI Large & Midcap	643.2	42325	1.3	0.6	3.8	12.2	13.0	13.8	0.41
****	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	258.5	26062	1.4	0.5	-0.5	12.3	10.0	14.0	0.34
****	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	192.8	3576	1.7	1.1	0.6	11.8	10.0	11.0	0.31
****	LIC MF Large & Midcap	39.3	3133	1.7	0.6	3.1	13.1	10.7	13.3	0.33
****	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	99.5	7222	1.5	0.7	10.8	14.3	11.5	14.1	0.35
****	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	962.3	5827	1.6	0.9	7.8	11.2	7.6	10.5	0.20
****	Navl Large & Midcap	36.9	313	2.1	0.5	6.3	8.7	9.6	11.8	0.29
****	Tata Large & Mid Cap	496.4	7901	1.5	0.6	-3.5	6.6	8.6	11.5	0.26

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2062.4	110736	1.1	0.6	3.6	15.6	17.1	15.2	0.61
*****	JM Flexi Cap	99.8	5185	1.6	0.5	3.0	13.7	14.5	15.1	0.45
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	82.5	148429	1.0	0.5	-2.7	12.6	11.3	16.1	0.43
*****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1963.6	28112	1.4	0.7	10.7	15.0	11.4	13.1	0.36
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	39.2	3613	1.6	0.5	3.7	13.9	11.7	13.7	0.35
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1597.6	19509	1.4	0.8	-0.9	11.2	11.8	12.5	0.37
*****	HSBC Flexi Cap	236.3	5718	1.6	0.9	8.8	15.9	12.7	12.6	0.36
****	Axis Flexi Cap	28.4	13478	1.5	0.7	6.2	13.6	8.2	-	0.23
****	Bandhan Flexi Cap	210.2	7575	1.5	0.9	1.5	10.9	9.6	10.4	0.29
****	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	343.1	13615	1.5	0.5	0.3	11.3	8.8	13.2	0.28
****	DSP Flexi Cap	103.3	12422	1.5	0.6	2.1	10.5	8.9	12.8	0.26
****	Kotak Flexi Cap	85.1	56119	1.2	0.5	1.6	11.4	9.9	12.3	0.31
****	Navl Flexi Cap	25.1	290	2.1	0.5	12.0	10.1	9.9	-	0.30
****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	37.1	5898	1.6	0.5	1.7	9.7	7.1	12.8	0.20
****	Union Flexi Cap	52.7	2404	1.7	0.8	4.2	10.8	9.5	12.4	0.29
****	LIC MF Flexi Cap	107.3	1075	1.9	0.9	8.2	11.4	9.9	10.2	0.29
****	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	63.6	13940	1.4	0.7	1.8	17.4	11.9	12.3	0.33
****	SBI Flexicap	108.8	22897	1.4	0.7	0.7	8.3	7.8	11.1	0.23
****	Tata Flexi Cap	23.6	3705	1.6	0.6	-2.8	9.4	8.1	-	0.25
****	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.7	134	2.1	0.8	-0.6	6.5	6.2	-	0.16
****	Taurus Flexi Cap	240.8	369	2.1	2.0	8.5	11.5	10.3	9.6	0.30
****	UTI Flexi Cap	32.7	24163	1.4	0.8	-0.3	8.4	4.7	11.3	0.11
****	- Quant Flexi Cap	107.6	7262	1.5	0.6	15.0	14.6	13.7	17.9	0.39

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	297.3	3432	1.7	0.8	4.2	14.1	12.7	13.4	0.37
-	ICICI Pru Multi Cap	865.7	18769	1.4	0.8	10.3	16.0	14.7	13.9	0.49
-	Invesco India Multicap	133.8	4398	1.6	0.6	3.4	13.2	11.2	13.1	0.30
-	ITI Multi Cap	26.3	1468	1.8	0.5	13.3	15.9	12.8	-	0.37
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	40.0	7184	1.5	0.5	15.2	16.3	15.0	-	0.43
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	301.8	55587	1.2	0.6	0.7	12.7	16.6	14.8	0.55
-	Quant Multi Cap	660.9	7717	1.5	0.6	9.0	9.0	10.9	16.8	0.29
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	397.5	2981	1.7	0.8	4.4	13.0	11.8	13.8	0.35

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	109.8	18693	1.4	0.4	9.5	20.2	17.6	17.7	0.51
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4512.7	50751	1.2	0.6	10.0	18.2	17.8	17.5	0.54
*****	Quant Mid Cap	220.2	8107	1.5	0.7	7.4	10.8	14.4	16.8	0.42
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	211.6	105143	1.1	0.6	10.0	17.6	19.0	16.7	0.62
*****	Invesco India Midcap	199.5	14721	1.5	0.5	11.1	22.9	19.0	18.1	0.52
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	36.8	5186	1.6	0.5	13.3	17.4	17.2	-	0.50
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	104.3	40036	1.3	0.7	-0.2	17.7	21.1	16.2	0.56
****	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	112.0	2584	1.7	0.5	11.6	16.2	14.3	14.7	0.43
****	HSBC Midcap	476.4	15578	1.4	0.5	22.0	23.8	18.2	16.8	0.48
****	ICICI Pru Mid Cap	346.6	7954	1.5	0.9	17.5	21.4	17.4	16.2	0.52
****	Kotak Mid Cap	146.8	69283	1.2	0.3	7.9	17.1	15.8	16.7	0.48
****	PGIM India Midcap	66.3	11071	1.5	0.5	0.9	10.8	9.9	14.7	0.30
****	SBI Midcap	242.3	24354	1.4	0.7	6.9	10.7	13.2	13.2	0.42
****	Sundaram Mid Cap	1505.7	14504	1.5	0.8	9.1	18.5	16.5	14.0	0.51
****	Tata Mid Cap	463.5	6056	1.6	0.5	8.6	14.0	14.0	15.4	0.44
****	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	857.7	6723	1.6	0.9	10.4	15.1	13.9	12.9	0.41
****	Axis Midcap	122.6	34404	1.3	0.5	8.4	15.9	12.4	16.4	0.37
****	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2845.6	12871	1.5	0.8	4.4	15.5	13.5	13.6	0.39
****	UTI Mid Cap	319.7	12795	1.5	0.7	6.6	11.9	11.7	13.3	0.34
****	DSP Midcap	156.4	20523	1.4	0.6	6.7	13.9	11.3	13.5	0.33
****	LIC MF Midcap	31.4	376	2.1	1.2	9.5	16.0	12.7	-	0.35
****	Taurus Mid Cap	128.9	135	2.1	1.7	6.6	9.2	12.3	14.0	0.34

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Bank of India Small Cap	58.4	2819	1.7	0.4	27.0	20.6	19.1	-	0.46
*****	Quant Small Cap	294.1	34069	1.3	0.6	17.0	16.8	19.2	20.1	0.45
*****	Edelweiss Small Cap	48.4	6818	1.6	0.4	10.6	14.6	16.4	-	0.46
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	48.7	14475	1.5	0.4	17.5	21.8	19.1	-	0.48

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	186.3	78957	1.1	0.5	10.9	14.7	18.8	20.3	0.49
*****	Union Small Cap	60.6	2402	1.7	0.8	23.6	16.4	16.9	16.4	0.42
****	AXIS Small Cap	117.8	30089	1.4	0.6	11.4	14.9	15.4	18.1	0.47
****	Canara Robeco Small Cap	41.4	14231	1.5	0.4	8.0	12.1	14.3	-	0.41
****	DSP Small Cap	232.7	20221	1.4	0.7	18.6	16.7	18.2	16.5	0.46
****	HSBC Small Cap	92.1	17784	1.4	0.6	14.7	13.8	17.5	17.9	0.42
****	Kotak Small Cap	276.4	18933	1.4	0.5	6.0	11.2	12.3	16.0	0.33
****	LIC MF Small Cap	35.8	758	2.0	0.8	18.7	17.8	17.8	-	0.43
****	Sundaram Small Cap	299.3	3922	1.6	0.7	17.0	16.4	16.6	14.4	0.43
****	Franklin Ind Small Cap	180.6	14467	1.5	0.8	7.1	12.5	16.0	14.3	0.42
****	HDFC Small Cap	139.8	41679	1.3	0.6	-1.5	9.9	14.6	16.4	0.39
****	ICICI Pru Small Cap	92.0	9533	1.5	0.7	4.1	10.5	13.9	15.0	0.43
****	Tata Small Cap	39.6	12696	1.5	0.4	-1.1	10.6	14.3	-	0.35
****	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	101.6	5865	1.6	0.8	20.7	15.0	13.7	12.7	0.34
****	SBI Small Cap	187.6	39955	1.3	0.6	8.7	11.7	14.2	17.8	0.41

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2156.0	629	0.3	0.2	6.8	6.5	6.5	6.2	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	452.5	69830	0.3	0.2	6.7	6.9	6.8	6.5	-
- Axis Liquid	3128.3	63343	0.2	0.1	6.9	7.0	6.9	6.5	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3388.1	20198	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3236.0	1825	0.1	0.1	7.0	7.0	6.9	6.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3225.7	13194	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.8	6.7	6.4	0.57
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3379.3	6783	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.7	6.8	6.4	-
- DSP Liquid	4009.6	22962	0.2	0.1	6.8	6.9	6.9	6.5	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3593.0	13272	0.2	0.1	6.8	6.9	6.9	6.5	-
- Groww Liquid	2714.8	381	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.8	6.8	6.4	-
- HDFC Liquid	5507.4	71323	0.3	0.2	6.8	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- HSBC Liquid	2798.8	20975	0.2	0.1	6.8	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	415.5	62798	0.3	0.2	6.7	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3859.5	20748	0.2	0.1	6.8	7.0	6.9	6.5	-
- ITI Liquid	1457.6	52	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.3	6.3	6.1	-
- JM Liquid	76.5	1743	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.8	6.7	6.3	-
- Kotak Liquid	5672.4	49073	0.3	0.2	6.7	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5074.7	17484	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.8	6.8	6.4	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1827.3	1392	0.2	0.1	6.9	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2941.6	17359	0.2	0.1	6.8	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.8	966	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.3	6.2	5.9	-
- Navi Liquid	30.3	74	0.2	0.2	5.6	5.9	5.9	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6851.1	43125	0.3	0.2	6.8	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1556.4	6722	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.8	6.8	6.4	-
- PGIM India Liquid	365.6	1031	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.9	6.4	-
- Quant Liquid	44.1	1426	0.5	0.3	6.4	6.2	5.9	5.8	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.4	556	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.2	6.0	5.9	-
- SBI Liquid	4386.5	92192	0.3	0.2	6.7	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2474.9	9094	0.3	0.1	6.6	7.1	6.9	6.4	-
- Tata Liquid	4421.2	32370	0.3	0.2	6.8	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- TRUSTMF Liquid	1362.7	1203	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- Union Liquid	2701.5	7578	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.9	6.8	6.4	-
- UTI Liquid	460.7	29218	0.2	0.1	6.8	6.9	6.9	6.5	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1508.3	743	0.2	0.1	6.9	6.9	6.7	6.3	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1475.6	10464	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1451.8	11325	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.2	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1456.3	1160	0.1	0.0	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1396.7	109	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.6	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1439.2	852	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1419.6	737	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- DSP Overnight	1465.7	3601	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1418.7	192	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1431.2	685	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.2	5.3	-
- Groww Overnight	1408.2	12	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	4037.1	12190	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1428.1	4535	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1474.0	14368	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1385.8	343	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- ITI Overnight	1382.3	14	0.2	0.1	4.6	4.7	4.8	4.9	-
- JM Overnight	1387.8	148	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	4.9	5.0	-
- Kotak Overnight	1458.6	8618	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1415.2	732	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1414.7	77	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1403.1	1727	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	146.9	8548	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1412.4	153	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.1	-
- SBI Overnight	4414.9	23407	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1451.5	1335	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1441.2	4571	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1438.6	411	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3725.6	5648	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.2	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.4	26939	0.9	0.3	0.3	6.4	5.4	5.7	-
- Axis Arbitrage	20.0	10339	0.9	0.3	0.7	6.2	5.4	5.7	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.6	8011	0.9	0.3	0.3	6.0	5.1	5.5	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.6	136	0.9	0.4	-1.5	4.7	4.5	5.1	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.1	1125	1.0	0.3	1.2	5.5	4.9	5.3	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.9	6646	0.9	0.3	0.4	6.1	5.3	5.6	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.7	15139	0.9	0.3	0.6	6.3	5.5	5.7	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.7	25001	0.8	0.3	0.1	6.1	5.4	5.7	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.3	2998	0.8	0.2	0.9	6.2	5.5	5.8	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.7	34180	0.8	0.3	0.4	6.4	5.5	5.8	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	34.1	29629	0.9	0.3	0.7	6.2	5.5	5.8	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.8	71	0.8	0.2	1.4	5.4	5.0	5.5	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.7	391	0.9	0.4	-1.0	5.4	4.9	5.3	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	40.1	74399	0.8	0.3	1.1	6.5	5.6	5.8	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.7	265	0.7	0.2	-0.6	5.9	5.4	5.6	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.1	132	1.0	0.3	-1.4	5.5	4.7	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.9	3872	0.8	0.1	1.1	6.2	5.3	5.6	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.3	16916	0.9	0.3	0.8	6.3	5.5	5.7	0.30
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.5	83	0.9	0.3	0.0	5.7	5.3	5.5	-
- SBI Arbitrage	36.1	46803	0.8	0.3	0.2	6.0	5.4	5.7	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.4	553	0.8	0.2	0.1	5.6	5.3	5.7	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.3	24725	0.9	0.3	1.0	6.1	5.4	5.7	-
- Union Arbitrage	15.0	226	0.9	0.3	0.1	6.7	5.6	5.7	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.5	11132	0.7	0.2	0.2	6.2	5.4	5.8	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TERM FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short Term	591.3	18819	0.5	0.3	6.5	7.2	7.3	6.5	9.15
***** Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Term	1662.0	666	0.4	0.2	6.5	7.0	7.1	6.5	-
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short-Term	1410.3	2066	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.1	7.2	6.4	11.75
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Term	16.4	4180	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
***** HSBC Ultra Short Term	1458.7	3628	0.3	0.1	6.6	7.0	7.0	6.3	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.8	15974	0.7	0.3	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.3	8.04
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Term	4330.3	12447	0.9	0.3	6.3	6.7	6.8	6.2	19.81
*** Axis Ultra Short Term	15.8	6074	1.1	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.6	5.9	10.15
*** DSP Ultra Short Term	3650.5	4456	0.9	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.7	5.9	6.81
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.3	17465	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.8	6.9	6.2	9.03
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Term	2898.8	1497	0.7	0.2	6.3	6.8	6.9	6.1	4.68
*** Kotak Ultra Short Term	46.0	15962	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.1	7.15
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Term	1478.8	222	0.6	0.3	6.3	6.8	6.9	6.1	2.03
*** SBI Ultra Short Term	6426.5	11880	0.5	0.3	6.4	6.8	7.0	6.2	10.96
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	15.2	6495	1.0	0.3	6.2	6.6	6.7	5.9	9.97
*** UTI Ultra Short Term	4546.2	3348	0.9	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.7	6.6	11.61
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Term	1457.3	584	0.7	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.5	5.9	-
** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3387.8	184	0.9	0.4	6.1	6.4	6.4	5.8	-
** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4070.0	582	0.8	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.5	5.7	-
** LIC MF Ultra Short Term	1414.0	678	1.2	0.2	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.7	2.26
** PGIM India Ultra Short Term	36.4	211	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.8	-
** ITI Ultra Short Term	1320.8	165	0.8	0.2	5.8	6.2	6.3	5.5	-
* Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.5	515	1.0	0.2	5.4	5.5	5.7	5.1	-
* Sundaram Ultra Short Term	2858.0	2416	1.3	0.2	5.4	5.9	6.0	5.3	1.28

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TO SHORT TERM FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short to Short Term	586.6	21047	0.5	0.4	6.5	7.3	7.4	6.6	6.09
***** UTI Ultra Short to Short Term	3819.4	2680	0.4	0.3	6.3	7.1	7.2	7.4	7.12
***** Axis Ultra Short to Short Term	3327.1	4558	0.6	0.3	6.2	7.1	7.1	6.3	7.59
***** Bandhan Ultra Short to Short Term	41.4	6404	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
***** HDFC Ultra Short to Short Term	61.9	17793	0.9	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.9	6.1	11.75

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

★★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short to Short Term	30.8	875	0.8	0.3	6.1	7.5	7.4	6.4	7.56
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Ult Shrt to Shrt Term	701.0	9727	1.0	0.4	5.6	6.5	6.6	5.9	7.94
★★★★	Canara Robeco Ult Shrt to Shrt Term	45.3	1111	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
★★★★	DSP Ultra Short to Short Term	21.3	4478	0.5	0.3	5.9	6.7	6.9	6.1	-
★★★★	Invesco India Ultra Shrt to Shrt Term	4057.3	1833	0.5	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	7.20
★★★★	JM Ultra Short to Short Term	39.7	215	0.7	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.8	6.0	3.48
★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Shrt to Short Term	2419.7	2434	0.7	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.8	5.9	6.15
★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Shrt to Shrt Term	4016.6	7933	0.8	0.3	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.1	5.09
★★★★	Tata Ultra Short to Short Term	4224.3	2871	0.5	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.2	4.04
★★★★	Kotak Ultra Short to Short Term	3576.9	12093	1.0	0.4	5.8	6.6	6.7	5.9	8.77
★★★	LIC MF Ultra Short to Short Term	42.4	2010	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.7	6.7	5.9	5.21
★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short to Short Term	1749.9	535	0.9	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.7	5.8	12.86
★★★	SBI Ultra Short to Short Term	3734.8	11622	0.8	0.4	5.7	6.6	6.7	5.9	4.62
★	Baroda BNP Pari Ult Shrt to Shrt Trm	42.9	382	0.9	0.2	5.8	6.5	6.6	5.8	-
★	Sundaram Ultra Short to Short Term	3690.4	446	1.0	0.3	5.4	6.5	6.6	5.8	1.42

TCS arm to set up 1 GW AI data centre in Hyderabad; to invest ₹70,000 crore

INFRA PUSH. HyperVault campus will aid high-density GPU deployments for AI training, advanced computing

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

HyperVault, a subsidiary of Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), will set up a 1 GW AI data centre campus in Hyderabad on 164 acres. The company and its partners envisage investing ₹70,000 crore to build the data centre campus, which will be developed in phases.

The announcement followed a meeting between TCS Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director K Krithivasan and Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy on Saturday.

The campus will be purpose-built to serve the needs of frontier AI companies and hyperscalers, enabling high-density GPU deployments for AI train-



FUTURE UNLOCKED. Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy at the unveiling of the AI data centre. Also present, Ministers Sridhar Babu, Uttan Kumar Reddy, Komatireddy Venkata Reddy, and Chief Secretary Sanjay Jaju as well as CEO and Managing Director of TCS K Krithivasan, K Rajanna, President of TCS HyperVault and Deepesh Nanda, CEO of HyperVault

ing, inference and advanced computing workloads.

TO USE GREEN ENERGY

The campus will also leverage green energy and water-neutral design principles. The project is expected to create 7,000 direct and indirect jobs.

“HyperVault advances

TCS’ Infrastructure-to-Intelligence strategy by bringing together AI-ready infrastructure with our cloud, engineering, enterprise transformation and AI capabilities. Hyderabad offers the scale, talent and ecosystem to serve global customers,” Krithivasan said.

“This reinforces Telan-

gana’s position as a strategic hub for artificial intelligence and advanced digital infrastructure. The project would boost the AI infrastructure ecosystem in the country. The project will generate several thousand direct and indirect jobs in the region,” a senior Telangana government official said.

AI AT SCALE

“This establishes that Hyderabad is now at the forefront of the global AI revolution with a strong focus on infrastructure,” Revanth Reddy said.

Deepesh Nanda, MD and CEO of HyperVault AI Data Center Ltd, said that the company was building infrastructure for where AI is going: Higher density, liquid cooling, larger power blocks and faster deployment.

“Hyderabad gives us the foundation to build that at scale for frontier AI companies and hyperscalers,” he added.

TCS’ decision to establish the data centre complex follows a meeting between Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran and the Chief Minister at Davos earlier this year.

Seized rabies vax not made by us: IIL MD

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai



Indian Immunologicals Ltd (IIL) is standing by its rabies vaccine Abhayrab, and called on authorities to trace the source of vials recently picked up from an “unlicensed” residential location in Delhi, bearing the same brand name and batch numbers of the original product.

“It is a mandatory practice for vaccines... every batch gets cleared by the national labs (before release into the market),” IIL Managing Director K Anand Kumar told *businessline*, adding that there were no complaints on their products (Batch KE25012) released only in the local market.

IIL was responding to enforcement action by the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) that had collected vials labelled as Abhayrab, Batch KE25012, from Delhi’s Mukherjee Nagar.

A CDSCO note said that as part of continued surveillance and enforcement, “on 22 April 2026, the Crime Branch, Delhi Police, along with a team of Drugs Inspectors... conducted a search at an unlicensed premises... Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi. During the search, Rabies Vaccine (Abhayrab) Batch No.KE25012, which was subsequently found to be misbranded (not manufactured by Indian Immunologicals Ltd.), was seized from the premises.”

These samples were sent to the Central Drugs Laboratory,

Kasauli, which reported them as “Not of Standard Quality” (NSQ) and misbranded, and the Drug Controller General of India then alerted State regulators on the findings, the CDSCO said.

Reiterating that “the samples under question were not manufactured by Human Biologicals Institute (HBI), IIL’s vaccine division”, IIL’s Anand said that the Central laboratory had identified 17 differences between the questionable vials and HBI’s retention samples of the same batch that were submitted for batch release.

According to Government data, the country reported 54 deaths from rabies, in 2024.

SECURITY FEATURES

In the last month, IIL has included six security features on its vaccines, including a scratch-card facility to check if the product was genuine, the MD said, as their product was a market leader, and this was the second such incident in recent times. Last December, Australian authorities had flagged counterfeit concerns on the vaccine. IIL had then clarified that the incident involved a single counterfeit batch that the company had flagged with the Indian drug regulator last January.

7.8% GDP growth amid global uncertainty reflects India’s economic strength: PM

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday said India’s 7.8 per cent first quarter GDP growth reflected the country’s “economic strength and potential” as it came despite the ongoing West Asia conflict and several trade-related challenges.

He said he had full faith in India’s capabilities to become a *Viksit* and *Atmanirbhar* nation while strengthening its position as a manufacturing and research and innovation hub, as well as an agriculture export super power.

Addressing the centenary celebrations of Delhi’s Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC), Modi said India, once described as one of the world’s ‘fragile five’, was now being watched as the fastest-growing major economy. “In just the past week, there have been several positive developments regarding India’s economy. The

7.8 per cent quarterly growth (in GDP) has boosted the country’s confidence,” he said.

Modi also pointed to an upgrade in India’s rating by a Japanese credit rating agency, saying the growth was particularly significant given the difficult external environment.

“And this 7.8 per cent growth has come at a time when the war in West Asia is ongoing and there have been several trade-related barriers. Achieving such growth under these circumstances shows India’s economic strength,” he said.

Referring to rising purchase of cars and growth in steel and cement consumption, the Prime Minister said it reflected growth in construction, housing, infrastructure and industrial activity. This means that both consumer demand and commercial activity in the country is strengthening, he added.

Taking a swipe at critics of the gov-

ernment’s economic performance, Modi said those who had labelled India a member of the ‘fragile five’ were finding the latest numbers difficult to digest. He urged people to examine the data seriously. “... those for whom the glass was half empty in 2013 continue to think the same way even today. For them, the glass will always be half empty. I talk about the glass; I am not talking about anything remaining empty,” Modi said referring to his address in SRCC in 2013 when he was the Gujarat CM.

Referring to India’s ‘policy dynamism’, Modi pointed out that countries across the world are increasing their partnership with India and the country had signed trade agreements and FTAs with about 40 countries over the last decade. “When new markets open and tariffs are brought down for India’s goods and services. This opens up new opportunities for India’s youth,” he added.

Will not interfere in SIA’s decision on investing in Air India: Singapore Minister

Bloomberg

The Singapore government said it will not interfere in any decision that Singapore Airlines Ltd. makes in Air India Ltd., which is said to be seeking financial aid from its shareholders.

Singapore Air has the responsibility to “assess its investments in Air India in relation to the resources it has for the long-term growth and profitability of the company,” Senior Minister K Shanmugam told reporters on Saturday. It’s the Singapore government’s principle to not intervene in individual invest-

ment decisions, or put political pressure, he said.

“Once governments or politicians start directing individual investment decisions, commercial discipline will be compromised,” according to a transcript of his comments. “Decisions will become politicised — shaped by political considerations, rather than commercial judgment. In the end, Singaporeans will bear the cost.”

Air India is close to securing \$1.1 billion in aid from its owners Tata Sons Pvt. and Singapore Air, as the carrier grapples with the fallout from a turbulent year, people familiar with the mat-

ter told Bloomberg this week.

The support would be proportional to shareholding, the people said, with Tata Sons owning 74.9 per cent of Air India and Singapore Air the remainder.

“We should leave it to SIA to decide what it does with its investments,” Shanmugam said. “Of course, SIA shareholders, as well as the broader public, have a right to expect that SIA will be accountable and transparent.”

He said that Temasek Holdings Pte, which is the majority owner of Singapore Air, — does not account to the government for its or its portfolio companies investment decision.

Eye on FTA, textiles sector in Europe push

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai



BOOST TIES. A high-level delegation comprising officials from the Ministry of Textiles and Representatives of leading trade bodies visited France and Italy

With the India-European Union Free Trade Agreement (FTA) expected to come into effect early next year, the textile and apparel industry is stepping up efforts to explore new markets and deepen relationships with existing buyers across Europe.

A high-level delegation comprising officials from the Ministry of Textiles and representatives of leading trade bodies visited France and Italy, where it participated in major exhibitions and also held discussions with major retailers, fashion brands and industry platforms.

The delegation included Neelam Shami Rao, Secretary (Textiles); A Sakthivel, Chairman, Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPIC); and M Beena, Development Commissioner (Handlooms).

MEETINGS HELD

In Paris, the delegation met officials of Monoprix, a major retail chain with a portfolio spanning fashion, gro-

cery, home and beauty products and a network of more than 500 stores across France.

The delegation also met officials of Okaidi, a leading French children’s fashion brand under the IDKIDS Group, which operates around 890 stores across 51 countries.

Meetings were also held with officials of luxury fashion house Chanel and LVMH, one of the world’s largest luxury goods groups, Sakthivel said in a social media post.

In another significant development during the Paris

visit, the Bharat Tex Trade Federation and Première Vision SA signed a Memorandum of Understanding on September 2.

The agreement aims to establish a multi-year institutional partnership to strengthen India’s engagement with the global fashion, textile and sourcing ecosystem.

MARKET ACCESS

The industry outreach assumes significance following the conclusion of negotiations for the India-EU FTA in January. The proposed agreement is expected to

provide preferential market access across a substantial share of India’s exports to Europe, with textile and apparel products among key beneficiaries.

The EU’s total textile and apparel imports in 2025 were valued at about \$292.8 billion, while India’s exports of these items to the bloc stood at around \$10.4 billion.

For Indian exporters, proposed zero-duty access across textile and clothing tariff lines could improve competitiveness in garments, textiles, yarn and home textiles against rival supplying countries.

IMMERSION CENTRE

Thirukkumaran Natarajan of Tiruppur Exporters Association (TEA) said one of the key decisions taken during the visit was to establish an Immersion Centre in Milan.

The proposed centre will seek to connect Indian apparel exporters more closely with European buyers, brands and industry stakeholders, creating opportunities for market access, collaboration and product development, he added.

Vice-President launches India Valves Registry

Our Bureau
Chennai

An India Valve Registry was launched at ‘India Valves 2026’, a national conference on valvular and structural heart disease held in Chennai on Saturday. The clinician-led, AI-enabled Registry will create a national database covering valve disease, treatments, procedures and long-term patient outcomes to generate India-specific evidence.

Vice-President CP Radhakrishnan launched the database in the presence of key delegates including Tamil Nadu Health Minister KG Arunraj and the management team of Apollo Hospitals.

The Vice-President said that a valve registry, by systematically recording information on patients, can transform individual clinical experiences into collective medical knowledge, as per a government statement.

Led by Course Director G Sengottuvelu, Interventional Cardiologist, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai, the three-day conference brings together top Indian and international experts.

Maruti Suzuki unveils new Baleno with Level 2 ADAS, prices start at ₹6.09 lakh

Our Bureau
Bengaluru



Bookings for the updated model are now open

Maruti Suzuki India on Saturday unveiled the new Baleno premium hatchback, introducing segment-first Level 2 Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS), ventilated front seats and a new design as the automaker looks to strengthen its position in the premium hatchback segment.

The new Baleno, positioned under Maruti Suzuki’s Nexa retail network, is priced from ₹6.09 lakh (ex-showroom, Bengaluru), with the company also announcing a special festive offer. Bookings for the updated model are now open.

DUAL TONE INTERIOR

The Baleno gets a new NEXA-Wave grille, redesigned front bumper, chrome-accented fender garnish and new colour option, ‘Enigmatic Teal’. The hatchback gets a dual-tone interior, leatherette upholstery and ventilated front seats, along with a 9-inch SmartPlay Pro+ infotainment system.

“There is no pressure but our aim is to cater to the cosmopolitan audience, so we are bringing ADAS 2.0,” said Partho Banerjee, Senior Executive Officer, Marketing and Sales, Maruti Suzuki.

Banerjee said the upgrade was driven by the company’s understanding of Baleno cus-

tomers rather than weak sales.

“The target customer to whom this Baleno is being positioned based on our ethnographic study, we need to offer him some more features,” he said.

The premium hatchback segment currently averages around 50,000 units a month, with the Baleno accounting for roughly one-third of sales, or about 16,500 Baleno units.

“This year, premium hatch industry is growing by 17 per cent. But at Maruti we are growing at 28 per cent,” Banerjee said. He added that the company expects the updated model to see strong demand.

“We feel there will be very good traction on this car. This car is doing very well,” he said.

Deadline for e-bus/truck motor localisation extended to April 2027

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

In a significant development regarding the import of rare earth magnets from China, the Centre has extended the manufacturing of traction motors for electric buses (e-Buses or M2/M3 category) and e-Trucks (N2/N3) under the Prime Minister Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement (PM E-DRIVE) Scheme.

The Chinese government has not yet granted any licences to Indian automotive companies for the import of rare earth magnets and, therefore, New Delhi had to extend the dates for manufacturing of traction motors for e-Buses by six months, from September 1, 2026 to now April 1, 2027, for the phased manufacturing programme (PMP) under the PM E-Drive scheme.

THIRD AMENDMENT

The PMP for e-Buses was notified by the Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI) on March 3, 2025, which was further amended on September 30, 2025 and again on March 13, 2026. So, this is the third amendment that the MHI has made due to the unavailability of magnets in the country.

With effect from April 1, 2027, “Manufacturing of traction motor which at least includes magnet fitment, fitment of rotor assembly into motor, fitment of stator assembly into motor, shaft fit-

ment, bearing fitment, enclosure fitment, connectors fitment, cables fitment shall be domestically performed,” the MHI said through a Gazette Notification dated September 3.

Similarly, for e-Trucks (N2/N3), the amendments state that the traction motor must be manufactured in India. This includes the magnet, rotor assembly, stator assembly, shaft, bearings, enclosure, connectors, and cables. For N3 trucks, this rule applies only where the motor has no integrated transmission. The PMP for e-Trucks was notified by MHI in July 2025 and further amended in September 2025, and again in March 2026 and April 2026.

However, since the import of REPM is now restricted by the Chinese government, companies have to rely on importing traction motors as complete units. Therefore, the MHI had to make these amendments, sources said.

“All the traction motors for heavy duty vehicles like the e-Buses or e-Trucks require permanent magnets, but there is a challenge of localisation here because of restrictions on import of those magnets from China. Therefore, the government had to extend the dates for localisation of these parts in India as the mathematics for incentives cannot be worked out under the PM E-DRIVE scheme,” a senior auto industry executive told *businessline*.

IndiGo to launch daily flights from Mumbai to Dar es Salaam in Nov

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Kaizad Pesi Postwalla, Head of Sales – International Markets, IndiGo Airlines, and airline’s representatives in Tanzania meet India’s High Commissioner Bishwadip Dey @INDIAINTANZANIA

IndiGo will launch flights to Dar es Salaam, Tanzania, in November, expanding its presence in the African market. Dar es Salaam will be its second destination in continental Africa and fourth overall, including Mauritius and Seychelles.

The Indian High Commission in Tanzania, in a recent post, said that IndiGo will start daily flights from Mumbai in November. This followed a meeting between airline executives and High Commissioner Bishwadip Dey.

IndiGo has not made a formal announcement about the launch. Currently, Air Tanzania operates flights between Dar es Salaam and Mumbai using a Boeing 787.

EAST AFRICA PUSH

IndiGo’s push in East Africa is part of its move to launch new routes and grow its presence in existing markets with high growth. It is also adding flights between

Mumbai and Hanoi, Vietnam, from October 25 to tap into leisure travel demand.

NETWORK TWEAKS

There have been other network tweaks too. It is pulling out of the Chennai-Reunion route from October. It is also returning its six damp-leased Boeing 787 planes and suspending flights to London Heathrow.

Abhijit DasGupta, Senior Vice-President (network planning and revenue management), had told *businessline* earlier that IndiGo will pursue both new routes and higher frequencies de-

pending upon where customer demand and network opportunities are the strongest.

DasGupta also said IndiGo sees opportunities to strengthen links between emerging commercial centres, tourism hubs and underserved markets.

businessline.

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